



CITY: Pg 3

Time's up for delays



NATION: Pg 5

SIT points to lapses by Rai in donation theft



FILM: Pg 10

Rani Mukerji to receive honorary doctorate

SC raps Patna HC over 'pressing woman's chest not attempted rape' ruling

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday questioned the reasoning adopted by the Patna High Court in a recent judgment that held pressing a woman's breasts and attempting to remove her salwar did not amount to an attempt to rape, with Chief Justice of India Surya Kant saying judges have a duty to conduct proper research before delivering such rulings. The court also directed that a handbook on judicial sensitivity in sexual offence cases be followed by courts nationwide and made available on the websites of the Supreme Court and all high courts.

The observations came during the hearing of the Supreme Court's suo motu proceedings arising from the Allahabad High Court's March 17, 2025 judgment, which had ruled that pulling an 11-year-old girl's pyjama string and grabbing her breasts amounted only to preparation and not an attempt to rape. The Supreme Court had stayed

Continued on P4

Govt unveils Rs 1.9 lakh crore mobile manufacturing, semiconductor push

NATIONAL INVESTMENT POLICY TO ADD FRESH 10 MN TONS UREA CAPACITY

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved seven major decisions covering infrastructure, semiconductor manufacturing, mobile phone production, fertiliser and railway projects. The package includes Semicon 2.0, the Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS) and the National Investment Policy for Urea-2026, with a combined outlay of Rs 2,19,353 crore.

Two major manufacturing initiatives with a combined outlay of nearly Rs 1.9 lakh crore (USD 22 billion) are aimed at expanding India's semiconductor ecosystem, scaling up mobile phone production and strengthening its position as a global electronics manufacturing hub.

The government approved the Rs 1.27 lakh crore (USD 14.6 billion) Semicon 2.0 programme to accelerate semiconductor design and manufacturing capabilities, alongside the Rs 62,500 crore



Ashwini Vaishnaw showcases a 'Made in India' semiconductor chip as he speaks during a cabinet briefing, in New Delhi, on Wednesday

Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS) aimed at increasing domestic production, boosting exports and deepening local value addition in the mobile phone industry.

The Union Cabinet also approved the National Investment Policy for Urea (NIPU-2026) to encourage fresh investments in gas-based urea manufacturing and achieve self-reliance in the country's most widely consumed fertiliser. The policy aims to facili-

tate the establishment of 8-9 new gas-based urea plants with a combined production capacity of 10 million tonnes and replaces the 2012 New Investment Policy with revised incentives.

Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said India's urea demand is growing by around five per cent annually due to changes in cropping patterns, increased sowing area and record agricultural pro-

CLOSER LOOK

- » Semicon 2.0 gets Rs 1.27 lakh crore
- » Mobile manufacturing scheme receives Rs 62,500 crore
- » NIPU-2026 approved for 8-9 new urea plants
- » Urea policy targets 10 million tonnes additional capacity
- » New urea policy saves over Rs 250 crore per plant
- » Two Varanasi highway projects worth Rs 25,500 crore approved

- » NH-31 corridor costs Rs 10,998 crore
- » NH-19 corridor costs Rs 14,448 crore
- » Varanasi corridors slash travel time by up to 67%
- » Semicon 2.0 targets Rs 4 lakh crore investment
- » Mobile exports targeted at Rs 15 lakh crore
- » Mobile scheme aims for Rs 39 lakh crore production
- » First semiconductor fab expected in 2028

duction. The country currently produces around 30 million tonnes of urea against an annual requirement of 40 million tonnes, making imports of about 10 million tonnes necessary. He said six plants commissioned under the earlier policy had significantly reduced import dependence, while the proposed new plants would make India self-reliant in urea production.

The revised framework separates fixed and variable

costs for greater transparency, introduces a return on equity band of 12-16 per cent and mitigates foreign exchange risk by converting fixed costs into rupees after four years based on prevailing exchange rates. The government estimates savings of more than Rs 250 crore for every plant established under NIPU-2026 compared with the previous policy. Vaishnaw said the incentive structure will remain the same for projects

Continued on P4

EC extends Delhi electoral roll revision timeline by 12 days

Draft roll now on Aug 17, final on Oct 19

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission (EC) has extended the timeline for the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Delhi by 12 days, postponing the publication of the draft electoral roll from August 5 to August 17. The revised schedule follows a request from the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Delhi, who sought additional time to complete the ongoing verification exercise.

According to the revised programme, the door-to-door verification of electors by Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will now continue until August 8 instead of the earlier deadline of July 29. The field verification exercise began across the national capital on June 30 as part of the nationwide revision of electoral rolls.

With the extension, the period for filing claims and objections has also been rescheduled. Citizens will now be able to raise objections or seek corrections in the draft electoral roll between August 17 and September 16. The



HIGHLIGHTS

- » BLOs' door-to-door verification extended till August 8
- » Verification drive began across Delhi on June 30
- » Claims and objections can be filed from August 17 to September 16
- » Earlier final electoral roll publication was scheduled for October 7

publication of the final electoral roll has been deferred to October 19 from the earlier date of October 7.

The Election Commission stated that all subsequent stages of Delhi's SIR exercise have been shifted by 12 days to accommodate the extended verification process.

Continued on P4

India-UK trade pact kicks in

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) came into force on Wednesday, marking a major milestone in bilateral economic ties by lowering tariffs, expanding market access and creating new opportunities for businesses, professionals and workers in both countries.

Under the agreement, Britain has immediately eliminated tariffs on 96.8 per cent of tariff lines, covering 97.7 per cent of the value of imports from India. India has removed duties on 64.1 per cent of tariff lines and will gradually phase out tariffs on another 21 per cent over the coming years. The pact is expected to boost

KEY POINTS

- » UK removes tariffs on 96.8 per cent tariff lines; India on 64.1 per cent
- » Pact expected to expand exports, investment and professional mobility between the two countries

Indian exports of textiles, leather, gems and jewellery, marine products, engineering goods and processed food, while giving British companies better access to India's markets in sectors such as automobiles, financial services, insurance and education.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi described the agreement as a "significant moment" that

would deepen economic cooperation and create fresh opportunities for businesses, farmers and workers in both countries.

The deal also includes a social security agreement under which eligible Indian professionals on temporary assignments in the UK will be exempt from paying UK National Insurance contributions for up to five years, preventing double social security payments. It also provides greater access to government procurement markets and facilitates the movement of professionals.

India exported goods worth \$13.44 billion to the UK and imported \$11.68 billion during 2025-26, while recording a services trade surplus of \$7.9 billion.

See P9

After data breach report, NPCIL says Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant safe

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: A ransomware group has published thousands of files purportedly linked to the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant on the dark web, prompting concerns over cybersecurity at India's largest nuclear facility. However, the Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited (NPCIL) said the incident did not affect nuclear safety or security. NPCIL acting Chairman and Managing Director Rajesh Veeraraghavan told NDTV that the leaked material related only to "common service balance of plant systems" and had

"no connection with nuclear safety and security."

According to a Reuters investigation, World Leaks posted nearly 19,000 files totalling 14.3 GB under the search term "KKNP", a finding first flagged by independent cybersecurity researcher Rakesh Krishnan. Reuters reviewed documents dated between 2016 and mid-2025 but said it could not verify their authenticity.

The files reportedly include blueprints, supplier details, inspection records, meeting minutes, equipment reviews, insurance documents and vendor proposals.

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Two killed in fire in Noida village building, landlord arrested

Seven fire tenders and 110 firefighters evacuated residents

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: Two young professionals were killed and more than 50 residents were rescued after a fire, suspected to have been triggered by an electric two-wheeler being charged, broke out in a residential building in Mamura village of Noida on Wednesday, officials said.

The blaze started on the ground floor of the building, where an electric two-wheeler was being charged. According to eyewitnesses, the vehicle's battery allegedly exploded, setting nearby petrol-powered two-wheelers on fire.



A fireman carries a woman rescued after a fire broke out in a multi-storied building at Mamura village, Sector 66, in Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar district, Uttar Pradesh, on Wednesday

PTI

Indian man stabbed 15 times in US after being asked about religion

UTAH: An Indian man was stabbed 15 times while working at a jewellery kiosk inside Valley Fair Mall in West Valley City, Utah, on Monday, in an attack that police are investigating. The victim, identified

as Sohail, suffered multiple stab wounds and was "bleeding profusely", according to a police affidavit.

Police arrested 48-year-old Peter Michael Larsen, who was booked into Salt Lake County

Continued on P4

Mbappé, France fall as Spain march into final



France's Kylian Mbappé (10) attempts a shot as Spain's Marc Cucurella (24) defends during the FIFA World Cup semi-final in Arlington, Texas

ARLINGTON (TEXAS): Spain booked a place in the World Cup final with a 2-0 semi-final win over France, keeping a sixth clean sheet in seven matches and extending their unbeaten run in regular time to 37 games. Mikel Oyarzabal converted a 22nd-minute penalty after Lamine Yamal won

a foul, before Pedro Porro doubled the lead in the 58th minute. "They were facing the best team in the world," Spain coach Luis de la Fuente said. France captain Kylian Mbappé failed to register a shot on target. Spain will face Argentina or England in Sunday's final, while France will play for third place.

See P10

PROPOSAL CUTS EARLIER 500% TARIFF PLAN

US Bill targets India, China with up to 100% tariffs for buying Russian oil

MPOST BUREAU

WASHINGTON/ NEW DELHI: A bipartisan group of US senators has introduced a revised Russia sanctions Bill that would allow President Donald Trump to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on the five largest buyers of Russian oil, including India and China, while expanding sanctions on Rus-

sia's energy, financial and defence sectors. The proposal marks a significant shift from an earlier draft that sought blanket tariffs of 500 per cent on countries importing Russian oil and gas. Lawmakers said the revised version was carefully tailored to target the biggest purchasers of Russian energy while providing limited exemptions for certain countries reducing their

dependence on Moscow.

The legislation, originally introduced in April 2025 by late Republican Senator Lindsey Graham and Democratic Senator Richard Blumenthal, identifies India, China, Slovakia, Hungary and Azerbaijan as the five largest buyers of Russian crude oil that could face tariffs of up to 100 per cent.

Continued on P4

ADDS NEW TWIST TO WORLD CUPS

ICC introduces a three-stage ODI World Cup, Super 10 in T20 event

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The International Cricket Council (ICC) has approved major changes to the formats of the 2027 ODI World Cup and the 2028 T20 World Cup, introducing additional competition stages and revised qualification pathways aimed at making every phase of the tournaments more significant. The decisions were taken at the ICC Annual Conference on Wednesday, with the governing body stating that the changes are designed to create "greater context and con-



sequence" from the opening matches through to the finals.

The 2027 ODI World

Cup in South Africa will feature 14 teams, an increase from the 10-team tournament held in the previous

edition. While the expansion had already been confirmed, the ICC has now introduced a three-stage

Continued on P4

Kidney transplants or euthanasia: Five C-section victims write to President

MPOST BUREAU

KOTA (RAJ): Five women battling severe kidney complications after caesarean deliveries at Kota's New Medical College Hospital (NMCH) have appealed to President Droupadi Murmu for permission to undergo euthanasia if they are not provided with kidney transplants. The women, who have been dependent on dialysis for over two months, refused further treatment and demanded either a transplant or death.

The families sent a memorandum to the President by speed post on Wednesday after receiving no response to an earlier plea

Continued on P4

Centre to track every Indian seafarer in Gulf

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: The Centre recently unveiled a comprehensive "Seafarer First" response to protect Indian crew members working in the conflict-hit waters of West Asia after missile attacks on two merchant vessels in the Strait of Hormuz left one Indian seafarer dead and several others injured. As part of the initiative, the government directed the Directorate General of Shipping (DGS) to create a vessel-by-vessel operational dashboard that will track every Indian seafarer on ships operating in the Persian Gulf, Strait of Hormuz and Gulf of Oman, regardless of the vessel's flag. The move is aimed at strengthening monitoring, improving emergency response and ensuring continuous support for Indian seafarers and their families amid rising maritime security risks in the region.

The decision came after missile attacks on oil tankers MT Al Bahiyah and MT Mombasa. The two vessels had a combined crew of 46, including 30 Indians. Indian seafarer Rohan Kumar was killed and another Indian was injured aboard MT Al Bahiyah. On MT Mombasa, nine Indian nationals sustained injuries, including two who remain in serious condition.

Union Minister for Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda

Continued on P4

HOMEOWNER QUESTIONED AFTER WORKER WAS FOUND LYING IN PARKING AREA

Driver runs over woman, takes her to hosp & returns body to accident spot

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

GURUGRAM: A 57-year-old domestic worker was allegedly crushed to death after being run over by an SUV while she was resting in the parking area of a residence in Gurugram's Sector 65. Police said they were alerted to the incident through a PCR call received at Sector 65 Police Station.

The deceased, identified as Guddi (57), was a native of Mahoba in Uttar Pradesh.

According to police, Guddi worked as a domestic help at house number 4011. After finishing her household chores on Tuesday afternoon, she was resting in the parking area when the incident occurred between 2 pm and 2.20 pm.

Police said the owner of the house was attempting to reverse



her Mahindra Thar out of the parking area when the vehicle allegedly ran over Guddi, who was sleeping on the ground.

The driver reportedly realised she had struck something after feeling an impact and immediately got out of the vehicle.

On discovering that Guddi had been crushed, the accused rushed her to a nearby private hospital.

After doctors declared the 57-year-old dead, she allegedly brought the body back to the residence, left it at the spot where the accident had occurred, and drove away without informing the police or neighbours, officials said.

Local residents later noticed Guddi lying in the parking area and alerted the police.

CLOSER LOOK

» Guddi worked as a domestic help at house number 4011. After finishing her household chores on Tuesday afternoon, she was resting in the parking area when the incident occurred between 2 pm and 2.20 pm

» According to the police, the owner of the house was attempting to reverse her Mahindra Thar out of the parking area when the vehicle allegedly ran over Guddi, who was sleeping on the ground

Two of 4 missing boys found dead in Yamuna

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Two of the four boys who went missing three days ago while bathing in the Yamuna have been found dead, police said on Wednesday as hopes for finding the other two alive recede with each passing hour.

After Rahul's body was recovered earlier in the day from the stretch of the river in the outer-north Delhi's Alipur area with the assistance of the Delhi Boat Club, another body, believed to be that of Amandeep, was fished out, the police said.

Teams from the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), Delhi Fire Service, Delhi Disaster Management Authority (DDMA) and Delhi



Teams from the NDRF, Delhi Fire Service, DDMA and Delhi Police continue to search for Anshu and Saurabh

Police continue to search for Anshu and Saurabh. The boys, all aged around 15, were swept far downstream by the strong current of the river on Sunday.

YEIDA revenue surges as board clears key development projects

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: The Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) more than doubled its revenue during the first quarter of the current financial year, earning Rs 1,371.75 crore by June 30 compared with Rs 640.01 crore during the corresponding period last year, registering a 114.33 per cent increase.

The financial performance was presented at YEIDA's 91st board meeting, chaired by Alok Kumar, chairman of the authority and additional chief secretary, industrial development department, on Wednesday.

The authority's expenditure also rose sharply to Rs 2,101.96 crore from Rs 944.80 crore a year earlier, with Rs 1,741.40 crore spent on land acquisition. Officials said industrial and mixed land-use schemes generated Rs 660.14 crore, nearly 47.5 per cent of the annual target for the category.

The board approved the development of an Industrial Node on the Agra side of the upcoming Noida International Airport to attract manufacturing and logistics investments.



It also reviewed a proposal to develop the YEIDA International Trade City, modelled on China's Yiwu International Trade City, as a global wholesale and export hub.

The board also reviewed progress across industrial parks, including MSME, Handicraft, Toy, Apparel and Medical Device parks. It approved the allotment of 30 acres in Sector 9 to the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) for advanced research facilities, earmarked Rs 50 crore to strengthen fire safety infrastructure in high-rise buildings, and cleared the allotment of 200 square metres to Yamuna International Airport Private Limited (YIAPL) for a scientific solid waste management facility.

FBD: 2 labourers killed as shop ledge collapses

OUR CORRESPONDENT

FARIDABAD: Two labourers were killed after the overhanging ledge of a closed shop collapsed on them here on Wednesday morning, police said.

According to police, the shop, located near Chawla Colony in Ballabgarh, had remained closed for the past three days.

The two men were standing beneath the shop's overhanging ledge when it suddenly collapsed at around 10 am, trapping them under the debris.

Local residents rushed to the spot, pulled the two out from under the debris and shifted them to a hospital, where doctors declared them dead.

The deceased, Amarjit Kumar and Santosh Kumar, both hailed from Begusarai in Bihar.



They worked as labourers and lived in rented accommodation in Jeevan Nagar Colony in Ballabgarh, police said.

Station House Officer Umesh Kumar said preliminary investigation suggested that continuous rainfall and the dilapidated condition of the overhanging ledge caused the collapse.

"The matter is under investigation. If any negligence comes to light, appropriate legal action will be taken," he said.

Delhi govt may seal buildings where previous water and sewer infra charges remain unpaid

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government may seal buildings where previous Delhi Jal Board (DJB) infrastructure fund charges (IFC) remain unpaid, Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Wednesday, alleging collusion between some builders and DJB officials.

Singh said a preliminary internal enquiry found several large group housing societies had been constructed without payment of the mandatory IFC charges. The government has sought details from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) of all building plans approved over the past five years to identify discrepancies.

According to the minister, around 300 properties measuring 3,000 square metres and above may have evaded the charges, causing an estimated revenue loss of Rs 2,000 crore to the DJB. He said unpaid dues would be recovered with penalties, and buildings could also be sealed. The government recently simplified the IFC policy, significantly reducing charges for larger properties while retaining exemptions for plots up to 200 square metres. **MPOST**

Two arrested for Dwarka man's murder over house sale dispute

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 38-year-old man was allegedly bludgeoned to death with an iron hammer over a dispute related to a house sale in Dwarka, with police arresting two suspects after analysing around 500 CCTV camera feeds, an officer said on Wednesday.

Police said the body of the victim, Akhilesh Mandal, was found on July 12 between a road and a drain near Kargil Chowk in Sector 18A in Delhi's Dwarka. The body had visible tattoos and a head injury, but no identification documents were found.

An FIR was registered at Dwarka North Police Station, and teams were formed to arrest the accused.

"During the probe, the team examined nearly 500 CCTV camera footage from the crime scene and adjoining routes, besides relying on technical surveillance to identify the victim and trace the suspects," the officer said.

Police said the arrested accused have been identified as Anil Thakur (66), a resident of Dharampura in Najafgarh who works as a security guard at a private bank, and Raju Kumar (28), a native of Bihar employed as a cleaning helper.

They said Mandal had been staying at Thakur's residence with his consent; however, frequent quarrels allegedly broke out between the two due to the victim's alcohol addiction.

"The dispute intensified after Thakur decided to sell his house, which Mandal allegedly opposed. Thakur called Man-

Court restores Khalid's 2 weekly e-mulakats

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court has allowed jailed activist Umar Khalid to have two weekly video meetings (e-mulakats) with his family after noting that he had availed the facility for the past six years without violating prison rules.

Additional Sessions Judge Sameer Bajpai passed the order on Khalid's application in the larger conspiracy case related to the 2020 northeast Delhi riots. Khalid's counsel said his two weekly e-mulakats were reduced to one in May without explanation. Despite the jail's objection citing prison rules, the court restored two weekly video meetings, noting his six-year record of compliance.

GOVERNMENT OF NATIONAL CAPITAL TERRITORY OF DELHI

HEADQUARTERS: DELHI FIRE SERVICE: NEW DELHI- 110001

Notice for Invitation of Applications for Third Party Auditors

Applications are hereby invited from the eligible Third-Party Auditors for their registration and empanelment with Principal Director of Delhi Fire Service as Fire Safety Auditor (Third Party).

In pursuance of the provisions contained in Delhi Fire Service (Amendment) Rule 2025, "Fire Safety Auditors" as specified in rule – (iv-a) read with Rule 35, 36, 37 and 38 of the said rules are authorised to issue Forms H, I, J and K for compliance of the provisions contained in these Rules.

The eligible and qualified persons or association of persons or companies are hereby informed to apply on Form "U" (<https://dfs.delhi.gov.in/dfs/forms>) along with all requisite and mandatory documents on e-mail id director.dlfire@nic.in to the Principal Director, Delhi Fire Service for their registration / empanelment to act as a Fire Safety Auditors categorically mentioning the subject as "Application for registration / empanelment as Fire Safety Auditor under DFS (Amendment) Rules- 2025".

For details of eligibility please refer schedule VII of Delhi Fire Service (Amended) Rules 2025 (https://dfs.delhi.gov.in/sites/default/files/Dfs/dfs_amendment_rules_2025.pdf).

Sh. Mukesh Verma, Divisional Officer (Mobile No. 9810445332) is the Nodal Officer for any query / clarification.

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0140/26-27

(Sachin Rana) IAS
Principal Director

CHILD DISCHARGED TWO DAYS AFTER OP

AIIMS docs perform rare lung surgery on 4-month-old baby

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Doctors at AIIMS New Delhi have successfully performed a rare lung-sparing surgery on a four-month-old infant born with Congenital Pulmonary Airway Malformation (CPAM), a birth defect in which part of the lung develops abnormally before birth. The infant, whose both lungs were affected, recovered well and was discharged just two days after the operation, making it one of the youngest reported cases of such a complex segment-level lung resection.

As the disease involved both lungs, the surgical team opted for a segmentectomy instead of removing an entire lobe. The procedure involved removing only segments 9 and 10 of the right lower lobe, among the most technically challenging parts of the lung because of their deep location, while preserving the surrounding healthy tissue.

The surgery was led by Professor Dr Vishesh Jain of the Department of Paediatric Surgery. He said one of the greatest challenges was operating on a moving lung. To create adequate working space, the affected lung had to remain completely motionless throughout the procedure.

Dr Jain credited Dr Abhishek from the Department of Anaesthesia for successfully isolating the affected lung using a small balloon-like device that prevented air from entering it. This enabled the sur-



geons to operate safely on a still lung despite the infant's tiny airway.

Explaining the procedure, Dr Jain said the lungs are divided into lobes, each of which contains smaller functional units known as segments. Each segment has its own blood supply and airway, but unlike lobes, they are not visible to the naked eye and require precise anatomical identification during surgery.

"Our biggest priority was to preserve as much healthy lung as possible because the disease involved both lungs. Removing only the affected segments instead of an entire lobe gives the child a better chance of normal lung growth and good respiratory function in the future. Such procedures demand meticulous surgical planning, close coordination with the anaesthesia team and advanced paediatric surgical expertise. We are happy that the baby recovered well and could go home within just two days," Dr Jain said.

— Nearly 70% of examined properties found without mandatory payment —
IFC irregularities trigger probe

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has launched a major investigation into suspected large-scale irregularities in the collection of Infrastructure Fund Charge (IFC), after a preliminary scrutiny revealed that nearly 70 per cent of examined properties had allegedly not paid the mandatory levy despite being liable to do so. The Delhi Jal Board (DJB) has now sought building approval records from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) for one year, five years and ten years to determine the extent of the alleged revenue loss and identify defaulting properties.

Speaking to *Millennium Post*, Delhi Jal Board Chairman and Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh Verma said the government had ordered a comprehensive inquiry into the matter and directed officials to obtain records from the MCD.

According to Verma, the DJB has completed scrutiny of building approval records for two years received from the MCD. The findings indicate that nearly 70 per cent of the cases for buildings spread over more than 3,000 square metres reflected zero payment of Infrastructure Fund Charge (IFC), even though the levy was appli-

KEY POINTS

- » The Delhi Jal Board has now sought building approval records from the MCD for one year, five years and ten years to determine the extent of the alleged revenue loss and identify defaulting properties
- » Speaking to *Millennium Post*, Delhi Jal Board Chairman and Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh Verma said the government had ordered a comprehensive inquiry into the matter and directed officials to obtain



records from the MCD
scrutiny of building approval records for two years received from the MCD
» According to Verma, the DJB has completed

cable. Officials suspect that this could point to widespread irregularities in the collection of the mandatory charge, resulting in significant loss of government revenue. Under existing provisions, buildings with a built-up area of up to 200 square metres are exempt from paying IFC. However, the charge is mandatory for larger constructions, particularly commercial buildings and other specified categories. Buildings spread over more than 3,000 square metres, where bulk utility connections

are provided, are also being examined separately as part of the investigation.

The preliminary assessment has identified around 300 properties where outstanding IFC dues could range between Rs 20 crore and Rs 50 crore each. Based on the initial findings, officials estimate that unpaid dues may amount to nearly Rs 2,000 crore.

Following these findings, the DJB has sought MCD records covering one year, five years and ten years to verify whether

the pattern extends beyond the cases already examined. The expanded scrutiny is expected to determine the actual scale of the alleged irregularities and the total amount recoverable.

Officials said the first step will be to issue notices to property owners found to have defaulted on IFC payments. They will be given an opportunity to explain their case and clear the outstanding dues. If the payments are not made despite notices, the government may initiate legal action, including

sealing of properties, recovery proceedings and, where necessary, auction of the properties in accordance with the law.

Emphasising the government's stand, Verma said, "Recovering every rupee of government revenue is our highest priority. If anyone has violated the rules by failing to pay the Infrastructure Fund Charge (IFC), the entire outstanding amount will be recovered in accordance with the law."

He added, "Notices will first be issued, giving the concerned parties an opportunity to present their case and make the payment. If the dues are still not cleared, action such as sealing, recovery proceedings and, if necessary, auction of properties will be carried out under the relevant legal provisions. No individual or institution is above the law. Protecting public revenue and ensuring fair enforcement of regulations is our responsibility, and any negligence in this regard will not be tolerated."

The investigation is expected to be one of the Delhi government's largest exercises to detect lapses in IFC collection, with officials indicating that the recovery process could involve dues worth thousands of crores if similar irregularities are found across records from previous years.

TIME'S UP FOR DELAYS

Delhi government approves Bill to make time-bound service delivery a legal right

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major governance reform aimed at ending bureaucratic delays, the Delhi Cabinet on Tuesday approved the Delhi Right of Citizen to Time Bound and Ease of Delivery of Service Bill, 2026, proposing to make time-bound delivery of notified government services a legal right. The legislation introduces a penalty mechanism under which officials responsible for unjustified delays can be fined Rs 250 per day, up to a maximum of Rs 5,000, while promising fully digital service delivery and automatic grievance escalation.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the proposed law would ensure citizens receive government services within fixed timelines while making departments more accountable and transparent.

"This Bill is intended to ensure that every citizen receives notified government services within the prescribed time frame. It also seeks to make government departments and officials more accountable for delays and negligence in service delivery," she said.

The proposed legislation will replace the Delhi (Right of Citizen to Time Bound Delivery of



The proposed law would ensure citizens receive govt services within fixed timelines while making departments more accountable and transparent
— CM GUPTA

digitally, reducing the need for repeated visits to government offices. A key feature of the Bill is its automatic escalation mechanism. If a designated officer fails to deliver a service within the prescribed timeline, the case will automatically move to the Citizen Grievance Redressal Authority without requiring the applicant to file a separate appeal. If the matter remains unresolved, it will be escalated to the proposed Delhi Right to Service Commission.

The Bill also provides for an independent statutory Delhi Right to Service Commission to hear second appeals, monitor implementation, inspect government offices, recommend disciplinary action against negligent officials and suggest administrative reforms. Highlighting the objective of the legislation, Gupta said, "The law will mark a significant step towards administrative reforms in Delhi and serve as a milestone in providing citizens with more transparent, simple, efficient and technology-driven public services."

She added that once implemented, the law would make governance "more efficient, transparent, responsive, citizen-centric and trustworthy," while strengthening public confidence in government services.



MCD, NDDDB sign MoU to set up CBG plants in Capital

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) and National Dairy Development Board (NDDDB) on Wednesday signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for setting up Compressed Bio-Gas (CBG) plants in the Capital for the scientific processing of cow dung. Union home minister Amit Shah called upon the initiative for developing a clean and green city.

The event was held in the presence of Union minister of state for animal husbandry and dairying, Rajiv Ranjan Singh (Lallan Singh), Delhi LG Taranjit Singh Sandhu, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, and several other officials from the centre and the state government.

Addressing the gathering, Amit Shah said that the project will not only help in making the city clean but also promote organic farming, produce clean fuel in the form of compressed biogas and add to the income of cattle owners. Shah also added

that the project will serve as a role model for other metro cities in the country.

Speaking on the development of the Yamuna river, Shah said that the river can only be cleaned when the sewage and waste thrown in it are properly treated. He added that nearly 80 treatment plants have been proposed in the national capital for the treatment of sewage and effluents.

The home minister said that arrangements have been made so that the dung of 1.25 lakh cattle does not get mixed with the Yamuna river. He further added that he is confident that not a single drop of untreated waste water will enter the river by December 2028.

As per the plan, the dung will be processed at Nangli, Ghoga-Goyla and Ghazipur waste management centres. The home minister announced that cattle owners will get one rupee per kg of dung. He said that the initiative would benefit the cattle owners by giving them an additional source of income.

Delhi eyes Diwali deadline for smart LED streetlights

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has set an ambitious target of completing most of its citywide Smart LED street-light project before Diwali this year, with the tendering process entering its final stage. Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh Verma said the contract is expected to be awarded within the next 10 to 15 days, paving the way for the rollout of the Rs. 473.24-crore initiative.

Speaking to *Millennium Post*, Verma said four to five companies have participated

in the bidding process and the government is aiming to complete the project ahead of the festival season.

"The tendering process has been completed and the contract is expected to be awarded within the next 10 to 15 days. Four to five companies have participated in the bidding. Our target is to complete the project before Diwali. Even if we are unable to achieve 100 percent completion, we expect at least 70 to 80 percent of the work to be finished by then," he said.

The project involves replacing nearly 96,000 conventional streetlights installed along PWD

roads with advanced Smart LED lighting systems integrated with real-time monitoring technology. The government also plans to install around 5,000 additional poles to eliminate dark spots, replace missing poles and meet future requirements.

Unlike the existing complaint-driven maintenance system, the new network will be connected to a Centralised Command Centre (CCC), enabling officials to monitor the functioning of every streetlight in real time. Any malfunction or outage will be detected instantly, allowing quicker repairs and reducing the chances of

prolonged dark stretches on city roads.

The government expects the modern lighting system to improve road visibility, strengthen women's safety and make public spaces safer after dark. The Smart LED lights are also expected to provide more uniform illumination, better lux levels and lower light pollution.

Apart from improving urban infrastructure, the project is expected to deliver substantial energy savings. Officials estimate that the upgraded lighting system will reduce electricity consumption by nearly 40 million units annually, translating

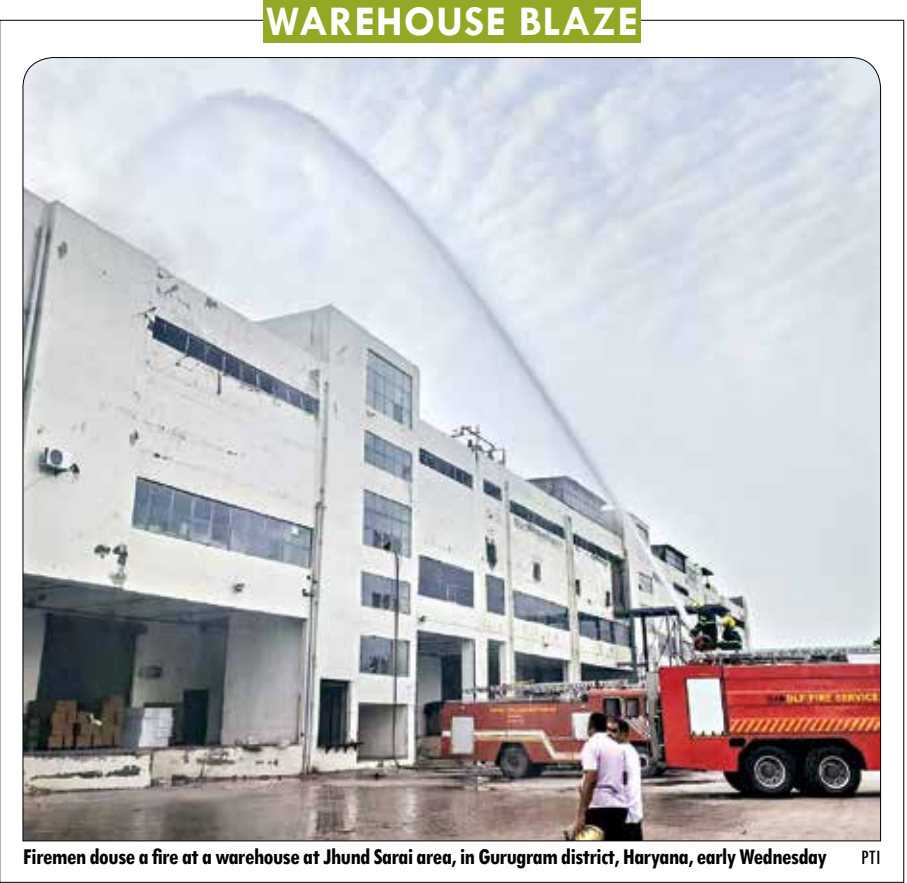
into savings of around Rs 25 crore every year.

The contract includes a seven-year warranty on lighting fixtures and five years of operation and maintenance by the selected contractor. It also incorporates performance-based service agreements, with incentives for efficient execution and penalties for delays or poor performance.

The government has adopted a deferred payment model, under which 25 per cent of the project cost will be paid upfront, while the remaining amount will be released in instalments over five years.



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE



Firemen douse a fire at a warehouse at Jhund Sarai area, in Gurugram district, Haryana, early Wednesday

Azadpur roundabout to get ATAL STATUE

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has decided to install a 15-foot-tall bronze statue of former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee at the Azadpur roundabout in north Delhi as part of a wider plan to develop the site and improve public infrastructure.

According to officials, the bronze sculpture will weigh around 1,500 kg. The Public Works Department (PWD) has floated a tender to appoint an agency for designing, casting and installing the statue. The selected firm has been given a three-month timeline to complete the work. Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood said the project is intended as a tribute to Vajpayee's legacy and contribution to the country.

"Former Prime Minister and Bharat Ratna awardee Atal Bihari Vajpayee was not

only a distinguished leader but also a symbol of visionary leadership, good governance and politics driven by national interest. His life and ideals continue to inspire millions to serve the nation selflessly," Sood said.

He added that the memorial would preserve Vajpayee's legacy for future generations while also enhancing the surrounding public space. Along with the installation of the statue, the government has planned a comprehensive beautification of the Azadpur roundabout. The PWD will undertake landscaping, improve street lighting and carry out repairs to the nearby foot overbridge. Basic public amenities will also be developed as part of the project.

Sood said the site is being envisioned not only as a memorial but also as a place that offers convenience to visitors while reflecting the ideals associated with the former prime minister.

Scattered pre-dawn rain in city

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi witnessed light showers in a few areas in the early hours of Wednesday, but the respite was short-lived as sultry weather returned, prompting the India Meteorological Department (IMD) to issue a yellow alert for hot and humid conditions ahead.

Safdarjung, the city's primary weather station, recorded a high of 38.4 degrees Celsius, 3.2 notches above normal and 0.2 degree lower than Tuesday, while the minimum settled at 29.1 degrees Celsius, 1.9 notches above normal and 0.7 degree higher than the previous day.

The station recorded a trace of rainfall between 2.30 am and 5.30 am on Wednesday. No further rain was recorded during the day, according to IMD data.

At Palam, the maximum temperature was 37.6 degrees Celsius, 2.4 notches above normal and 0.8 degree lower than Tuesday, while the minimum was 24.2 degrees Celsius, down 2.6 degrees from the previous day. Lodhi Road recorded a high of 38.3 degrees Celsius and a low of 28.4 degrees Celsius, 0.3 degree and 0.2 degree higher than Tuesday, respectively.

Ayanagar and Najafgarh each recorded 1 mm of rainfall between 11.30 pm on Tuesday and 2.30 am on Wednesday. No rainfall was recorded at any weather station in the city after that period. The IMD has issued a yellow alert for Thursday.

"A yellow alert has been issued for Thursday, as hot and humid conditions are likely in isolated parts of the city," an IMD official said. According to the IMD forecast, the maximum temperature on Thursday is likely to remain between 37 and 39 degrees Celsius, while the minimum is expected to be between 27 and 29 degrees Celsius.

STRENGTHENS STANDING COMMITTEE MAJORITY
BJP dominates MCD ward committee polls

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) won control of 10 of the 12 Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) Ward Committees in elections held on Wednesday, significantly strengthening its position ahead of the formation of the corporation's influential Standing Committee. The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) secured victories in only two zones Rohini and Karol Bagh.

Several BJP candidates were elected unopposed. In Najafgarh Zone, Jaivir Singh Rana was elected Chairman, Sushma Rathee Deputy Chairman, and Shashi Yadav Member of the Standing Committee. Keshav Puram also witnessed an uncontested BJP sweep with Vineet Vohra, Meenu Goel and Sushil elected to the three posts. Similarly, Central



Zone elected Neetu, Praveen Kumar and Hem Chand Goel unopposed, while Narela saw Janta Devi, Dinesh Kumar and Pawan Kumar secure the three positions, with the latter two elected unopposed.

The BJP also retained South Zone, where Dharamvir Singh

and Mamta Yadav defeated AAP candidates by 12 votes to 10. The result sparked allegations of cross-voting, as the zone has an equal strength of BJP and AAP councillors along with two Congress councillors. Shahdara North elected Pankaj Luthra as Chairman and

Brijesh Singh as Deputy Chairman with a 20-12 margin, while Shahdara South elected Yashpal Singh as Chairman (18-6), with Raju Sachdeva and Munesh elected unopposed as Deputy Chairman and Standing Committee member, respectively.

In Civil Lines, Gulab Singh defeated the AAP candidate 11-8, while nominated member Sanjay Tyagi won the Deputy Chairmans post after securing 11 votes. Usha Sharma won the Chairperson's election in City-SP Zone by 7-5, while AAP's Shamim Bano was elected Deputy Chairperson unopposed. In West Zone, BJP's Harish Oberoi won the Chairmanship 14-11, but AAP's Dimple Ahuja secured the Deputy Chairperson's post by 13-12.

AAP retained Rohini, where Pushpa and Ramesh Chand won by 12-11, and Karol Bagh, where Alka Dhingra, Kavita Chauhan and Rajan Arora were elected unopposed. The outcome gives the BJP a decisive advantage in the process of constituting the MCD Standing Committee, one of the civic body's most powerful decision-making panels.

Govt unveils Rs 1.9 lakh crore mobile manufacturing, semiconductor push

Continued from Page 1

Promoted by private companies, public sector enterprises and cooperatives.

The Cabinet also approved two highway projects for Varanasi involving a combined investment of nearly Rs 25,500 crore to ease traffic congestion and improve connectivity across the city. One project involves the construction of a 43.218-km elevated corridor linking NH-31 with the Varanasi Ring Road along the Varuna River at a cost of Rs 10,998.32 crore. The second is a 46.039-km corridor connecting NH-19 with the Ring Road along the Ganga at Rs 14,447.64 crore. Both projects will be implemented by the National Highways Authority of India under the Hybrid Annu-

ity Model.

According to the government, the projects will reduce travel time between NH-31 and Kashi Railway Station from about 40 minutes to 20 minutes and cut travel time across the NH-19 corridor from around 60 minutes to 20 minutes. They will also improve access to Lal Bahadur Shastri Airport, major railway stations, Ramnagar Port, Kashi Vishwanath Temple, Banaras Hindu University, Namo Ghat and other key destinations, while supporting tourism, logistics and economic growth in eastern Uttar Pradesh.

The semiconductor programme builds on the first phase of the India Semiconductor Mission and will focus on six key areas: chip design,

semiconductor equipment and materials, fabrication facilities, advanced packaging and testing, research and development, and talent development.

“The Union cabinet under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi has approved Rs 1.27 lakh crore for Semicon 2.0,” Minister for Electronics and Information Technology Ashwini Vaishnaw said at a news briefing.

The government expects the new scheme to attract investments of around Rs 4 lakh crore and lead to semiconductor production worth Rs 2 lakh crore during the scheme period. India is also expected to export chips worth Rs 1 lakh crore. “Guidelines of the schemes will be published in about 20 days,” the minister said.

Vaishnaw said the scheme will support the indigenous production of chips designed in India with domestic ownership.

In contrast to the previous plan, the new scheme will provide incentives in the form of grants against equity or link them to royalty-based funding.

“The government will mimic proposals of private investors in the chip firms,” a MeitY official said.

The government has reduced incentives for setting up new chip plants from 50 per cent to 40 per cent for silicon fabs and to 35 per cent for other fabs.

The Union Cabinet also approved the Rs 62,500 crore Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme to provide production-linked incentives to manufac-

turers over five years from FY27 to FY31, Vaishnaw said.

“We expect to more than double the export of mobile phones to around Rs 15 lakh crore under the new scheme from around Rs 7.5 lakh crore under the previous scheme,” the minister said.

Incentives will range from 2.25 per cent to 5 per cent on eligible mobile phone sales, with additional support for domestic sourcing of key components and for Indian companies investing in product design and research.

The government expects the mobile phone scheme to drive cumulative production of around Rs 39 lakh crore during its tenure, significantly increase exports and generate about 60,000 direct jobs.

India has emerged as the world's second-largest mobile phone manufacturer by volume, with 99.2 per cent of mobile phones used domestically now manufactured within the country.

Mobile phones became India's largest exported product category in 2025, overtaking traditional export segments such as diesel fuel and cut diamonds.

Semicon 2.0 aims to encourage the development of semiconductor intellectual property, commercial and strategic chip designs, and manufacturing capabilities for critical components required across sectors. The programme will provide support to companies involved in semiconductor machinery, materials, chemicals and gases

while seeking to attract additional fabrication plants to India.

A government statement issued after the Cabinet meeting said the initiative would strengthen supply chain resilience and help establish India as a key semiconductor design and manufacturing destination. The country's first semiconductor fabrication unit is expected to begin operations in 2028.

The programme also seeks to expand Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging (ATMP) and Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) capabilities, while advancing research into more sophisticated chip technologies.

India's semiconductor push has already resulted in approvals for 12 manufacturing projects

with a combined investment of more than Rs 1.64 lakh crore.

These include a silicon fabrication plant, a silicon carbide facility, an integrated gallium nitride micro-LED display unit and nine packaging facilities catering to sectors such as automobiles, telecommunications, consumer electronics, aerospace and industrial equipment.

Three approved projects by Micron, Kaynes and CG Semi have begun commercial production, while another facility is expected to start operations in 2026. The first phase has also supported 24 semiconductor design projects by startups and MSMEs, with 105 companies receiving access to industry-standard Electronic Design Automation tools.

From Page 1

EC extends

Delhi is among the states included in the third phase of the nationwide Special Intensive Revision programme launched by the Election Commission on May 14. The exercise is aimed at ensuring electoral rolls remain accurate and updated through extensive field verification by election officials. Once the third phase is completed, the revision process will have covered the entire country except Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, and Ladakh.

Earlier this week, the Commission also revised the timelines for Andhra Pradesh and Haryana, which are part of the same phase. In both states, the deadline for house-to-house verification by Booth Level Officers was extended from July 14 to July 24, resulting in the publication of the draft electoral rolls being shifted from July 21 to July 31.

The Election Commission has made similar adjustments to the SIR schedule in several states in recent weeks, citing administrative and logistical requirements. The staggered extensions are intended to provide election officials with adequate time to complete verification and ensure that electoral rolls are accurate before the publication of the final voter lists.

SC raps Patna

that verdict on March 26, 2025 after taking suo motu cognisance and had described it as reflecting “total insensitivity”.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joy-malya Bagchi and V Mohana took note of the Patna High Court judgment after senior advocates Shobha Gupta and H S Phoolka informed the court about it. Gupta told the bench that such orders were being passed repeatedly, including the Patna High Court's July 9 ruling. Justice V Mohana asked whether the Supreme Court's earlier directions on judicial sensitisation had been cited before the Patna High Court.

Referring to the latest ruling, the Chief Justice remarked, “There is a duty cast on judges also to do some research. The staff is doing nothing.”

The Supreme Court directed that the National Judicial Academy Committee's report on judicial sensitivity in sexual offence cases be uploaded on the websites of the Supreme Court and all high courts. It further ordered that all courts follow the language and guidance contained in the handbook, while states must instruct police stations to use it during registration of FIRs and filing of charge sheets. The bench also said it would upload a reasoned judgment.

The Patna High Court judgment, delivered by Justice Purnendu Singh, arose from a 2008 case involving a photography studio in Amarpur, Bihar's Banka district. According to the prosecution, the studio owner locked a woman inside after asking her father to wait outside, attempted to remove her salwar, pressed her chest and allegedly intended to rape her. Hearing her cries, her father forced open the door, after which the accused fled.

A trial court convicted the accused in 2013 under Sections 376 read with 511 of the IPC for attempt to rape and Section 342 for wrongful confinement, sentencing him to three years' rigorous imprisonment.

Allowing the appeal, the High Court found serious gaps in the prosecution's case, noting that the investigating officer and medical officer were not examined and that there was no medical evidence sup-

porting the allegation of attempted rape. It also observed that one independent witness had turned hostile and the prosecution mainly relied on the testimonies of the survivor and her parents.

The High Court held that, even if the prosecution's allegations were accepted in full, there was no evidence of penetration or any overt act that unequivocally established an attempt to commit rape. It ruled that the accused's actions amounted to outraging a woman's modesty under Section 354 of the IPC rather than attempted rape, set aside the conviction, acquitted him of all charges, discharged his bail bonds and ordered the refund of any fine deposited.

NPCIL

Reuters reported that they appear to relate mainly to Units 3 and 4, which are under construction and are expected to become operational by 2027, adding 2,000 MW to the plant's capacity.

Reliance Group, a contractor at the project, told Reuters that there had been a “partial breach” of data stored on servers hosted by third-party data centre operator Yotta. The company said the government had been informed but did not specify what information had been compromised. Yotta said it detected suspicious activity on May 29, stopped the suspected ransomware execution and later shared its technical findings with Reliance, while adding it could not verify the claims made by the attackers.

Reuters also reported that NPCIL is coordinating with Reliance, while the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) is investigating the incident.

Nickolas Roth, senior director at the Nuclear Threat Initiative, told Reuters that the breach could pose a “serious” risk because such documents could help attackers identify suppliers, map support systems and detect possible security gaps. Reuters reported that the leaked files do not appear to involve the nuclear reactors' core systems supplied by Russia's Rosatom.

This is the second reported cyber incident linked to Kudankulam. In 2019, malware was detected on the plant's administrative network, but NPCIL said at the time that reactor operations remained unaffected.

Two killed

However, officials said the exact cause of the blaze is under investigation.

The fire quickly spread through the parking area, triggering a series of explosions as fuel tanks and tyres caught fire. Thick black smoke engulfed the building, trapping residents on the upper floors and plunging the structure into darkness after the electricity supply failed.

As panic spread, residents rushed to balconies and windows, shouting for help. Some attempted to jump from the building fearing suffocation, but were persuaded by police and firefighters to remain calm until rescue teams reached them.

Firefighters and police launched an extensive rescue operation immediately after receiving the emergency call. More than 50 people, including women, children, senior citizens and employees resting after night shifts, were evacuated from the smoke-filled building.

Chief Fire Officer Pradeep Kumar Chaubey said the rescue operation was particularly challenging as petrol-powered vehicles parked on the ground floor continued exploding.

“Bursting tyres and burning fuel generated dense smoke, reducing visibility almost to zero. The narrow

approach lane also prevented fire tenders from reaching the building directly, forcing teams to lay long hose lines from a distance,” he said.

The victims were identified as Sneha Srivastava, a resident of Bihar, and Rishabh Kumar, a native of Madhya Pradesh. Both worked for private companies in Noida and lived separately as tenants in the building. They suffered severe burn injuries and smoke inhalation after being trapped in the blaze and were declared dead at the district hospital.

The fire department said the ground-plus-four building had around 10 to 12 rooms on each floor that were being used as residential flats, most of them occupied by employees working in Noida and Greater Noida's IT, BPO, electronics and manufacturing sectors. Officials estimated that between 50 and 70 people were inside the building when the fire broke out.

A preliminary inspection revealed major fire safety lapses. Officials said the building lacked fire extinguishers, smoke detectors, fire alarms and hydrant systems. An FIR has been registered, and the building owner, who is also the leaseholder, has been arrested for alleged violations of fire safety norms.

The blaze destroyed more than a dozen two-wheelers and was brought under control after nearly two hours with the help of seven fire tenders and around 110 firefighters. Joint Commissioner of Police, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Rajiv Narain Mishra supervised the rescue operation, while police, fire and health department personnel coordinated efforts to evacuate residents and provide medical assistance.

Authorities have launched an investigation into the exact cause of the fire, while officials said the incident has once again exposed serious concerns over inadequate fire safety compliance in densely populated residential buildings.

Indian man

Jail on suspicion of attempted murder and prohibited dangerous weapon conduct.

According to investigators, Larsen first asked Sohail for a bottle of water. As Sohail turned to get it, he allegedly launched the attack. Colleagues said Larsen had earlier asked Sohail where he was from and whether he was Muslim. Sohail told him he was from India and confirmed his religion before the stabbing began, his colleague Luna Nunez told ABC4.

Authorities have not officially confirmed the motive and said the investigation is continuing.

Sohail was working a regular shift at a jewellery kiosk owned by Maga Incorporated Diamonds. “He is a father; he has two kids. His kids were waiting home for their father,” kiosk owner Adnan Mohammed said, thanking bystanders whose intervention helped save Sohail's life. Calling for unity, he said, “There is not space for hate. I believe in only one religion which is humanity.” AGENCIES

US Bill targets

Blumenthal said the proposal goes far beyond tariffs.

“It has been referred to as a tariffs Bill, but actually it imposes full blocking sanctions on wide swaths of the Russian economy, including its energy industry, financial industry, defence industrial base, oligarchs, business people, and Vladimir Putin himself,” he told reporters.

He said the tariff provisions were “narrowly tailored” and that US allies in Europe were not the focus of the legislation.

The revised Bill creates an exemption for countries importing less than 15 per cent of Russia's

natural gas exports if they are taking meaningful steps to reduce those purchases. Lawmakers said the provision could apply to several countries, while maintaining pressure on the biggest buyers of Russian energy.

Besides tariffs, the measure targets Russia's so-called shadow fleet of oil tankers, the Central Bank of the Russian Federation, major financial institutions and state-backed energy projects, including Yamal LNG and Arctic LNG 1, 2 and 3. It also gives Trump authority to waive sanctions if he determines doing so serves US national interests.

Senate aides said the Bill has 26 co-sponsors and expressed confidence it has a strong chance of passing after months of negotiations with the White House.

Trump said he supported the legislation and suggested sanctions on Iran and Hezbollah could also be added. “This is in honour of Lindsey. This was his thing. He wanted this more than anything,” Trump said.

Blumenthal urged lawmakers to move ahead without broadening the proposal, saying, “We should move forward with this Bill rather than opening it, in my view, to other potential targets.”

Lawmakers said the sanctions are intended to increase economic pressure on Moscow over its continuing war in Ukraine while discouraging major economies from financing Russia through energy purchases.

Pawar NCP

use the 2011 census as the basis for redrawing constituency boundaries, a proposal that previously faced fierce opposition from INDI Alliance parties who argued it would disproportionately benefit northern states at the expense of southern regions.

During an April 2026 special parliamentary session, the INDIA grouping voted unanimously against the legislation, successfully blocking its passage in what marked the first defeat for the Modi government's constitutional amendments in 12 years.

If Sharad Pawar's move is confirmed, it would mark a break from the Opposition's united stand after parties voted together against the Bill during the last Parliament session. The latest development has renewed speculation of the NCP reuniting and lending support to the NDA at the Centre in some form.

Meanwhile, addressing a press conference on Wednesday, NCP (Sharad Pawar) MP Supriya Sule refused to confirm the speculation but indicated that the faction's stand on the Bill would depend on its final shape and form.

“If the government provides for a 50 per cent increase in seats across all states and clearly outlines its implementation, we will support it,” Sule told reporters.

The condition echoes the party's earlier position and aligns with an assurance given by Union Home Minister Amit Shah in April, when he said the government was willing to amend the Bill to provide for a uniform 50 per cent increase in Lok Sabha seats across all states and ensure that no state was disadvantaged by the delimitation exercise.

“If the reason to oppose this Bill is that there should be a 50 per cent increase, then halt the proceedings for an hour, and I will bring an official amendment to this Bill,” Shah had said during the debate in the Lok Sabha.

“After a 50% increase, their seats will rise to 195, which will be 23.87% of 816 seats. No one will be at a loss,” Shah had argued, however, the proposed amendment was never incorporated into the final text.

The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026, introduced to increase the strength of the Lok Sabha to 850 seats and

operationalise women's reservation, failed to secure the required two-thirds majority in the Lok Sabha on April 17.

In a post on X, senior Congress leader P. Chidambaram urged the two regional parties not to support the legislation, arguing that delimitation under the existing formula would unfairly disadvantage states that had successfully controlled population growth in line with the National Population Policy.

The government is expected to introduce the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill during the Monsoon Session of Parliament beginning July 20.

Separate meetings between senior leaders of two NCP factions with Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis at his residence here renewed speculation about political realignments and a merger, weeks after six MPs of Shiv Sena (UBT) switched to ruling Shiv Sena.

Centre to track

Sonowal chaired a high-level inter-ministerial review meeting to assess the security situation and India's preparedness. Union Minister of State Shantanu Thakur, senior officials from the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, the Ministry of External Affairs, the Indian Navy, the Directorate General of Shipping, Indian missions in Iran and Oman, and other maritime agencies attended the meeting.

The proposed dashboard will provide real-time details on vessel location, ownership, cargo, crew strength, crew welfare, threat assessment, intended voyage, next port of call and the availability of facilities. Sonowal directed that every Indian seafarer in the affected region be individually accounted for, irrespective of the flag under which the vessel is operating.

The minister also ordered real-time vessel monitoring, the appointment of dedicated liaison officers for every affected Indian seafarer and round-the-clock coordination involving the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, the Ministry of External Affairs, the Indian Navy, the Directorate General of Shipping, Indian missions in Iran and Oman, and other concerned ministries and agencies.

Expressing grief over the attacks, Sonowal condemned the targeting of civilian merchant vessels.

“India has expressed its strong resentment and objection to the manner of attacks on defenceless civilian merchant vessels. These have resulted in the death and serious injury of Indian seafarers who, as key workers ensuring the proper functioning of global supply chains, are victims of irresponsible, unwarranted and uncalled-for attacks,” he said.

“I am profoundly hurt and aggrieved by the unfortunate and tragic loss of one more of our brave and innocent seafarers along with the injuries suffered by others. I convey my heartfelt condolences to the bereaved family. We shall ensure that our seafarer's families are supported and cared for. I want to assure every Indian seafarer and their family that the entire government is committed to assisting you in every possible way,” Sonowal added.

Each affected Indian seafarer will be assigned a dedicated liaison officer who will act as the single point of contact for families. These officers will coordinate medical updates, travel documentation, family assistance, repatriation, support through the Seafarers Welfare Fund, settlement of outstanding wages, contractual benefits and other compensation.

The minister instructed officials to maintain close coordination with Indian missions in Iran, Oman, the

United Arab Emirates and other affected countries to obtain verified information on navigational safety, coastal advisories, shipping routes, port-of-refuge arrangements, hospitals, medical evacuation, repatriation procedures, management of mortal remains and the progress of investigations.

Sonowal said India has also taken up the matter at multilateral forums of the International Maritime Organization (IMO) and with the concerned flag administrations involved in the incidents, saying the attacks violated international conventions on seafarer safety and the right of innocent passage for merchant vessels.

He further directed that every vessel transiting the conflict-affected region undergo a fresh threat assessment before sailing, with voyages proceeding only after the ship master's professional judgement and coordination with maritime authorities. Shipowners, vessel managers and Recruitment and Placement Service Licence agencies employing Indian seafarers have also been asked to submit compliance reports confirming that no Indian crew member is being compelled to sail without adequate information, protection and support.

The government has also activated a 24x7 grievance support system through domestic and international toll-free helplines, WhatsApp and email to assist Indian seafarers and their families during the crisis.

Five C-section

submitted to district authorities seeking kidney transplants.

The five women have undergone 32 rounds of dialysis over the past 68 days. Five other women treated at NMCH and JK Lone Hospital died from complications following caesarean deliveries.

“We cannot watch them suffer like this anymore. If they do not give us a written assurance for kidney transplants within 48 hours, we will stop bringing them for dialysis,” said Mohan Lal, whose wife Dhanni Suman has been hospitalised since early May.

The prolonged treatment has pushed several families into financial hardship. Mohan Lal sold his taxi to meet expenses, while Ragini Meena's husband lost his job after leaving work to care for her. Ragini now requires dialysis every 48 hours to survive, according to her brother Vikas.

NMCH Principal Dr Nilesh Jain said all five women were medically stable and fit for discharge for the past 20 days, adding they could continue dialysis as outpatients. He warned that refusing dialysis could lead to life-threatening complications and said kidney transplantation cannot be considered until patients are observed for three to six months before being assessed for end-stage renal disease.

The Rajasthan government has ordered an investigation into the post-delivery complications. It has also banned certain substandard drugs supplied to hospitals, though officials said they were not directly linked to the kidney infections. Similar maternal deaths have also been reported from Bikaner, Bhilwara and Banswara.

ICC introduces

competition before the knockout rounds.

According to the ICC, “the revised format will entail a three-stage competition leading to the Finals, which creates greater context, competitiveness and consequence during the event, ensuring

meaningful competition from the opening match through to the Finals.”

Under the new structure, the teams qualifying in positions 12th to 14th will first compete in a Super Series round. The winner of that stage will join the remaining teams in the next phase, where six teams will be split into two groups.

The top three teams from each group, along with the next highest-placed team across both groups, will progress to a newly introduced Super 7 stage instead of the previously planned Super 6. From there, the top four teams will qualify for the semifinals before the finalists are decided.

The ICC said the revised system would increase the importance of every match while continuing to provide opportunities for developing cricket nations.

“The increased consequence and enhanced competitive intensity promise to enhance the overall experience for fans while continuing to provide emerging teams with the opportunity to compete on cricket's biggest stage,” the governing body said.

Qualification for the ODI World Cup has also been outlined. Ten teams will earn automatic places in the tournament. Co-hosts South Africa and Zimbabwe qualify automatically as full members, while fellow co-host Namibia, an associate member, will not receive direct qualification. The remaining automatic places will go to the eight highest-ranked teams in the ODI rankings, with the final four spots to be decided through a global qualifying tournament.

The ICC has also overhauled the format for the 2028 T20 World Cup, which will be jointly hosted by Australia and New Zealand. The second stage of the tournament will expand from the Super 8 to a Super 10.

The event will begin with five groups of four teams each, with the top two sides from every group advancing to the Super 10 phase.

Unlike the previous format, where the top two teams from each Super 8 group reached the semifinals, only the group winners in the Super 10 will qualify directly for the last four. Teams finishing second in each group will face the third-placed side from the opposite group in eliminator matches, adding another knockout step before the semifinals.

“Encouraged by the performance of emerging teams in the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026, the ICC has decided to increase the number of teams competing in the second stage of the tournament from 8 to 10,” the ICC said.

The qualification pathway has also been revised. Scotland will move directly into the Europe Regional Final after replacing Bangladesh at short notice during the 2026 T20 World Cup. Teams from the 2026 edition that did not secure automatic qualification will advance to the Global Qualifier.

The remaining eight places in the Global Qualifier will come through regional qualification, with two teams each from Africa, Asia and Europe, and one each from the Americas and East Asia-Pacific.

The highest-ranked team from each region at the Global Qualifier, along with the next three best teams overall, will qualify for the 2028 T20 World Cup.

The ICC said the new tournament structures have been endorsed by its Board following recommendations from the Development and Chief Executives' Committees. Final approval will be considered after a review by the Finance and Commercial Affairs Committee at the Board's November meetings.

SIT REPORT LIKELY TO BE SUBMITTED TODAY

SIT points to lapses by Champat Rai in Ram Temple donation theft

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: The Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the alleged theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya has reportedly held former Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust General Secretary Champat Rai responsible for administrative negligence and failure of oversight, according to sources familiar with the investigation.

The detailed SIT report, which is expected to be submitted to the Uttar Pradesh government soon, stops short of accusing Rai of any criminal conspiracy.

However, it reportedly concludes that weak supervision and dilution of recruitment procedures and standard operating protocols created conditions that enabled the alleged theft.

Sources said the report identifies former trustee Anil Mishra as bearing the highest level of responsibility for changes in recruitment practices and relaxation of oper-



Champat Rai recently said he would respond after SIT files final report PTI

ational norms. The SIT has reportedly described these changes as one of the key reasons behind the security and financial lapses.

The state government had given the SIT time until July 15 to complete its detailed investigation. The report is understood to be in its final stage and may be submitted at any time.

According to sources, the investigation found that Rai, who was overseeing the temple's day-to-day admin-

istration, cannot be given a complete clean chit. While the report does not attribute any criminal role to him, it reportedly holds him accountable for negligence in monitoring the temple's management. The question of criminal conspiracy has been left to the ongoing police investigation.

The SIT is also learnt to have raised serious concerns over the recruitment process. Most of the employees arrested in the case were outsourced

housekeeping staff who had been assigned the sensitive task of counting donations. Sources said many of them were recruited on the recommendations of trust functionaries instead of through a transparent selection process. The report reportedly concludes that deviation from established recruitment norms significantly contributed to the alleged theft.

The investigation has also highlighted changes made to

Highlights

- » The detailed SIT report, which is expected to be submitted to the Uttar Pradesh government soon, stops short of accusing Rai of any criminal conspiracy
- » Sources said the report identifies former trustee Anil Mishra as bearing the highest level of responsibility for changes in recruitment practices and relaxation of operational norms
- » The SIT has reportedly described these changes as one of the key reasons behind the security and financial lapses

the temple's standard operating procedures. According to sources, the dilution of these protocols weakened internal checks and created opportunities for financial irregularities.

The SIT has further examined the role of Ramshankar Yadav alias Tinnu Yadav, whose influence within the temple administration was found to be much greater than his official position.

Although he did not hold a formal administrative post, the report reportedly notes that he had access to sensitive operational information and played an active role in temple management. It also points out that he had custody of the donation box keys, a responsibility for which Rai has been held indirectly accountable.

The report has also flagged shortcomings in the trust's audit mechanism and recommended greater transparency in financial oversight, particularly in the handling and accounting of jewellery offered by devotees.

LS Secretariat bars protests, sloganeering, placards in House

'Avoid smartwatches that compromise security'

NEW DELHI: Ahead of the Monsoon session, MPs have been cautioned by the Lok Sabha Secretariat against staging demonstrations, "dharna", showing placards, carrying firearms and performing religious rituals in the Parliament House complex.

The Monsoon session of Parliament is scheduled to begin on July 20 and conclude on August 13.

In separate parliamentary bulletins, the Lok Sabha Secretariat also said it has noticed that AI-generated portraits, pictures and slogans of a derogatory nature are being displayed on posters, placards and banners, adding that the members should not indulge in such a practice in the Parliament complex during the session.

"Members are requested not to hold protests or demonstrations in front of gates of Parliament House as such actions cause serious hindrance to the movement of members to the Parliament chambers during sittings of the Houses. Here attention of members is drawn to Direction 124A(2) of



Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla delivered the inaugural address at the 'Legislative Pride Journey: A Gathering of Former and Current Members', organized as part of the Amrit Mahotsav MPOST

the Directions by the Speaker, Lok Sabha. Keeping building gates free from any blockage is also essential for ensuring safety and security of members in the Parliament House. Kind cooperation of Hon'ble members is solicited," a bulletin said.

The MPs have also been requested not to use the precincts of the House for any demonstration, "dharna", strike or fast for the purpose of performing any religious ceremony.

In another bulletin, the Lok Sabha Secretariat said in order

to keep the area and passages within the Parliament House Estate free and open for MPs, without any obstruction or hindrance, a number of activities are prohibited within the complex. These include carrying firearms, banners, placards, "lathis", spears, swords, sticks etc. Parliament has seen long disruptions of its proceedings due to opposition protests, sloganeering, the display of placards on different issues, leading to adjournments and virtually no work for days.

Meanwhile, the secretariat also advised the MPs not to use smart watches, or smart spectacles in ways that may compromise the security, privileges and privacy of members in the Parliament Estate during the upcoming Monsoon Session.

"Members are aware that a large number of advanced devices such as smart spectacles/ pen cameras/ smart watches etc. are now widely available in the country. Some of these devices can be used in ways so as to compromise the privacy of Members and breach parliamentary privileges," a bulletin stated. MPOST

Heavy rush for Ram Temple CEO post; over 1K apply

Ex-IAS officers, Army official, journalists among hopefuls

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: The race to become the first Chief Executive Officer of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust has attracted an unusually diverse pool of candidates, with retired IAS officers, former IPS officers, an ex-Army Lieutenant General and even journalists joining more than 1,000 applicants from across the country.

The overwhelming response has prompted the temple trust to consider expanding the number of applications to be scrutinised by the selection committee. Officials said around 1,000 applications had been received and the number could rise further before the scrutiny process begins.

Among the prominent applicants is retired IAS officer and former Uttar Pradesh Chief Secretary Alok Ranjan, who confirmed that he had applied after learning about the vacancy through media reports. "Finding myself suitable under the criteria laid down by the Ram Janmabhoomi Trust for the post of CEO, I have submitted my application," he said.

Former Uttar Pradesh Director General of Police Vikram Singh has also applied for the post. Retired Lieutenant General Vishnu Thakur, who has served in counter-insurgency operations and was posted in Lucknow as a Corps Commander, is another applicant. Retired bureaucrat Kant Chaturvedi, who earlier served as Additional Chief Secretary in Uttar Pradesh and later chaired the Shri Sai Sansthan Trust in Shirdi, has also entered the race.

The post has also drawn interest from journalists and professionals from the private sector, reflecting the national appeal of one of the country's most prestigious temple management positions.

Officials said applications would first be segregated according to eligibility before detailed scrutiny begins. "Around 500 applications were



Around 500 applications were received within hours of the notification

received within hours of the notification being issued. With such a strong response in less than 24 hours, the total number of applications is expected to reach several thousand by the closing date. A separate committee will therefore be required to examine the applications in accordance with the prescribed eligibility criteria," a Trust member said.

The Trust has constituted a three-member selection committee headed by former Chief Election Commissioner Sushil Chandra. The panel also includes former Intelligence Bureau chief Arvind Kumar and former Uttar Pradesh Chief Secretary Manoj Kumar Singh.

Sources said the committee is expected to meet after the July 19 deadline for applications. Eligible candidates will then be shortlisted and invited for interviews. The committee will submit its recommendations to the Trust, which will take the final decision.

The CEO will oversee the administrative and operational management of the Ram Temple, supervise the Trust's projects and coordinate with government agencies and other stakeholders.

According to the eligibility criteria, applicants should be below 58 years of age, have at least 20 years of administrative experience and be willing to reside in Ayodhya.

They should also be proficient in both Hindi and English. The notification gives preference to candidates with experience in managing large institutions or organisations. Salary will be negotiated with the selected candidate. The appointment will initially be for three years and may be extended based on performance.

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SCEIA WILL CONSIST OF SIX MEMBERS

Centre creates state bodies for faster green nods

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Environment Ministry has notified the constitution of two new standing bodies to expedite the green clearance process in states and Union Territories.

The new bodies would assume the functions of the existing State Environment Impact Assessment Authorities (SEIAA) and State Expert Appraisal Committees (SEAC) whenever these state-level institutions become non-functional for more than one month due to the expiry of their tenure or delays in reconstitution, or stay imposed on their functioning by court.

While the SEIAA grants environmental clearances, the SEAC advises it in appraising the project.

The ministry had proposed

Highlights

» While the SEIAA grants environmental clearances, the SEAC advises it in appraising the project

» The new bodies are called Standing Authority on Environment Impact Assessment (SAEIA) and Standing Committee on Environment Impact Appraisal (SCEIA)



» The SCEIA will be assisting SAEIA in clearing the projects

the creation of the new bodies back in March in a draft notification, resulting in experts raising concern over the criteria for selecting their members, as they argued that this could lead to a weakened scrutiny of projects.

That is because unlike in the case of the Centre's Expert Appraisal Committee (EAC), and state's SEIAA and SEAC under the Environment Impact Assessment (EIA) Notification,

2006, the chairpersons and all members of the new bodies do not need to have domain experience, such as being experts with 15 years of experience or a PhD in relevant fields.

The new bodies are called Standing Authority on Environment Impact Assessment (SAEIA) and Standing Committee on Environment Impact Appraisal (SCEIA). The SCEIA will be assisting SAEIA in clear-

ing the projects.

The SAEIA will comprise three members -- chief secretary or advisor to the administrator or lieutenant governor as chairperson; principal chief conservator of forest (head of forest force) as a member; and an officer of the state or Union territory government working as special secretary or joint secretary or deputy secretary in the environment department as a

member secretary.

The SCEIA will consist of six members. Administrative secretary of the environment department of state or Union territory as chairperson; chief wildlife warden as a member; director general or director of health services of the state as a member; and member secretary of state pollution control board or Union Territory pollution control committee as a member.

It will also have a domain expert, who would be director or principal of Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) or National Institute of Technology (NIT) located in the state or Union Territory or their nominees as per requirement.

In the absence of IIT or NIT, the domain expert will be nominated by director of the National Environmental Engi-

neering Research Institute.

There will also be an officer of the state or Union Territory government working as special secretary or joint secretary or deputy secretary in the environment department as the member secretary of the SCEIA.

According to the ministry's latest notification, published on Tuesday, the new bodies will function for not more than a year in the case that state committees are dysfunctional.

Moreover, the ministry has amended the EIA Notification, 2006, to extend the tenure of the SEIAAs and the SEACs from three years to four years.

It has also made it mandatory for state governments to initiate the process of reconstituting SEIAAs and SEACs "at least six months before the expiry of their tenure".

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

‘Government cruel for ignoring Wangchuk’s fast,’ says Dipke

Activist completes day 18 of hunger strike



Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk amid his hunger strike, at Jantar Mantar, in New Delhi, Wednesday

PTI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Activist Sonam Wangchuk struck the 18th day of his hunger strike on Wednesday, as MPs cutting across party lines visited Jantar Mantar and founder Abhijeet Dipke accused the government of being "cruel" for refusing to meet him. The Ladakhi activist is under round-the-clock medical supervision.

The BJP's protest over alleged irregularities in the NEET examination entered its 26th day. The outfit also announced a one-day mass hunger strike on Thursday ahead of its "Chalo Sansad" march on July 20.

According to the medical bulletin issued by the CJP, Wangchuk remains "very weak" and is under 24-hour medical vigilance. His weight has fallen to 57.15 kg, a drop of 400 grams in the last 24 hours, and 8.9 kg since he began his hunger strike.

His blood pressure was recorded at 105/76, blood sugar at 80 mg/dL, oxygen saturation at 97 per cent, while hydration was described as fair.

Doctors said he is conscious and mentally alert but requires continuous monitoring.

"Day 18 of Sonam Wangchuk's hunger strike. The man who chose to put his own life on the line to seek justice for students who died by suicide

has received nothing but silence from the government. The government is not just unaccountable; it is also cruel," Dipke said in a post on X.

Support for the agitation gathered momentum as the day wore on, with Bhim Army chief and Nagina MP Chandrashekar Azad, Samajwadi Party MPs Mohibullah Naqvi and Ajendra Singh Lodhi, Trinamool Congress Rajya Sabha MP Dola Sen, Congress Lok Sabha MP Prashant Yadao Rao Padole, and CPI Rajya Sabha MP Sandosh Kumar visiting the protest site.

According to the CJP, the MPs assured the protesters that their issues will be raised strongly in the Monsoon Session of Parliament, as well as at the all-party meeting on July 19.

Comedian Kunal Kamra also visited the protest site. CJP spokesperson Ashutosh Ranka claimed Jantar Mantar was packed with supporters and said, "A tsunami is coming. Time's running out for this government." On Tuesday, Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee, Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav, Shiv Sena (UBT) chief Uddhav Thackeray, and AAP national convenor Arvind Kejriwal appealed to Wangchuk to end his fast, while veteran actor Zeenat Aman urged the government to initiate dialogue with the activist.

Law students arrested for creating ruckus in SC

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested two Lucknow University law students for allegedly creating a ruckus in the Supreme Court and disrupting the proceedings of the country's highest judiciary institution on the grounds of the Chief Justice of India.

An FIR has been registered at Tilak Marg Police Station in this regard with sections 132, 221, 224 and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) and other relevant sections.

According to the police, the incident occurred on July 10, inside Court No. 13 while hearing SLP No. 31367/2026, Prabal Pratap & Another vs State of Uttar Pradesh. The main accused in this case is Prabal Pratap Singh (24), a third-year law student of Lucknow University and a resi-

dent of Etawah, Uttar Pradesh, who appeared in the court as a petitioner-in-person.

Police alleged that he created chaos in the court by using obscene and abusive language.

Moreover, he allegedly threw papers at the court and created a disturbance. When Supreme Court security personnel tried to control him, he allegedly attacked them physically and prevented them from doing their duty. Chander Bhan (23), a second-year law student of Lucknow University and a resident of Rae Bareilly, Uttar Pradesh is the second accused in this case.

After observing comments made by these law students, the Supreme Court sent them to the Institute of Human Behaviour and Allied Sciences (IHBAS) for a medical examination, which concluded that they do not need psychiatric intervention.

KGMU's non-veg ban triggers political row in UP

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The King George's Medical University (KGMU) decision to ban non-vegetarian food in all hostel messes and canteens has snowballed into a political controversy, with opposition leaders criticising the move while BJP leaders and some religious figures defended the university's autonomy.

The controversy erupted after KGMU Chief Provost Kamal Kumar Sawlani issued an order on Tuesday directing that non-vegetarian food should neither be cooked nor served in hostel messes and canteens. The order, which came into effect immediately, asked hostel authorities to include protein-rich vegetarian food in students' meals to ensure adequate nutrition.

Amarnath Yatra: J&K L-G reviews arrangements at Jammu base camp

Manoj Sinha says treat yatris as 'divine guests'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

JAMMU: Jammu and Kashmir Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha on Wednesday visited the Bhagwati Nagar Yatri Niwas here and reviewed the facilities and services put in place for Amarnath Yatra pilgrims.

The lieutenant governor held a meeting with senior officials of the Jammu and Kashmir Police, Army, security forces, Shri Amarnathji Shrine Board and civil administration to assess the arrangements at the base camp.

"I visited Bhagwati Nagar Yatri Niwas in Jammu today to review the facilities and services in place for the ongoing Shri Amarnath Ji Yatra," he took to X.

Noting that the annual pilgrimage has crossed the three-



J&K L-G Manoj Sinha

MPOST

lakh mark within 12 days of its commencement, Sinha said ensuring a smooth, safe and hassle-free experience for devotees remains the administration's top priority.

He commended the efforts of all agencies involved in the conduct of the pilgrimage and urged them to treat every pilgrim as a divine guest.

Sinha stressed the need for

flawless registration, comfortable accommodation and seamless travel arrangements for devotees visiting the holy cave shrine of Baba Barfani.

He also directed the officials to showcase the tourism potential of the Jammu region by organising sightseeing tours for pilgrims to important spiritual and tourist destinations across the Jammu division.

Punjab govt has fulfilled every promise: CM Mann

MPOST BUREAU

Closer Look

» CM said his politics is not about holding on to power but about ensuring progress of

people

» Mann called upon people to give AAP a massive mandate on the basis of its pro-people works

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Wednesday asserted that Punjab's journey towards becoming the number one state in every sector would continue with the support and trust of its people, saying the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government has fulfilled every promise made to the people through transformative initiatives in education, healthcare, power and social welfare.

During a massive public gathering in Mukerian Halqa, the Chief Minister said his politics is not about holding on to power but about ensuring the progress and prosperity of the people of Punjab.

The Chief Minister said that while his government remained focused on empowering people and delivering on its commitments, the Congress is busy fighting for power and has already declared that

everyone will be injured due to their intense infighting."

The Chief Minister called upon the people to give the AAP such a massive mandate, on the basis of its pro-people works, that these opportunistic leaders do not get a chance to form the government and fight for the Chief Minister's chair.

"Do not hand over power to these greedy leaders because they will stop all the schemes started by the AAP government for public welfare. The Congress leaders have repeatedly claimed that if voted to power, they will discontinue these schemes," he said.

Taking potshots at the Akali Dal, Mann said, "The Akali Dal

wants to capture power by making false promises to the people, but the people of Punjab will not be misled by them. The people elected the Badals as Chief Minister five times, but they never did anything good for the state or its people."

Taking a jibe at Akali Dal Chief Sukhbir Badal, he said, "The Akali leaders have lost their base among the people. They are using paid workers to show crowds at their rallies. The same crowd is seen at every Akali rally. These people once claimed that they would rule Punjab for 25 years, but the wise and courageous people of the state pushed them into political oblivion. These opportunistic leaders change their colours and their stand like a chameleon according to their convenience and vested political interests. The entire state knows their real face because they have always misled the people through political gimmicks."

Haryana village's drinking water woes resolved with Khattar's intervention



MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: A long-standing drinking water issue in Chanot village of Hansi was resolved on Tuesday following the intervention of Union Minister for Power, Housing and Urban Affairs, Manohar Lal Khattar, who approved the installation of a new four-inch tee (T) connection from the main drinking water pipeline to the village, prompting the protesting villagers to withdraw their agitation.

Addressing a press conference after chairing a meeting at the PWD Rest House in Hansi on Wednesday, the Union minister said that two key issues concerning Chanot village had emerged during the execution of the state's drinking water pipeline project. The villagers had demanded that the village also be connected to the main drinking water pipeline passing nearby. Additionally, the alignment of the pipeline had been affected by technical and administrative challenges arising from the widening and construction of the National Highway, resulting in delays to the project.

The public representatives held detailed discussions with villagers, members of the protest committee, and departmental officers, carefully heard all stakeholders, and arrived at a mutually acceptable solution on the spot.

Khattar said the govt treated the villagers' demand with due seriousness and sought detailed reports from technical experts and departmental officers.

The assessment confirmed that the main pipeline has sufficient capacity and that providing an additional water connection to Chanot village would not adversely affect the drinking water supply to any other village or area.

Solar Power Project under 'Green Panchayat Scheme' commissioned

ASHWANI SHARMA

SHIMLA: Marking a landmark beginning in the under Green Panchayat scheme, a 500 kW ground-mounted solar power project was commissioned at Gram Panchayat Mamlig in Solan district on Wednesday.

Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu, who has taken major initiatives to generate solar power in the state inaugurated the project. The revenue generated from the project will be shared directly with the Panchayat for development and other welfare programmes.

Under the Green Panchayat Scheme, the state is rolling out 500 kW ground-mounted solar plants across Gram Panchayats. "The electricity is sold to HPSEBL at a fixed rate, and the revenue is shared directly with the local Panchayats to fund

Revenue generated from project will be shared directly with Panchayat for development

village development and welfare programmes," said the chief minister.

The state has allowed private individuals and investors to set up ground-mounted solar projects ranging from 250 kW to 5 MW on a "first come, first served" basis.

Mamlig project, built at a cost of Rs 2 crore, began construction of the project began on December 23, 2024 and it was connected to the electricity grid on February 24, 2026.

The Chief Minister said the project was currently generat-

ing around 3,000 units of clean electricity every day and was expected to produce nearly eight lakh units annually. Under the power purchase agreement, the Himachal Pradesh State Electricity Board Limited would purchase the electricity at Rs 3.50 per unit, providing the state with clean energy as well as a stable source of long-term revenue.

He said the project's biggest strength was its people-centric revenue-sharing model. 25 per cent of the income generated under this project would be used for development works in the Gram Panchayat, another 25 per cent on the welfare of orphans and widows, 20 per cent would go to the state government, 20 per cent to HIMURJA, and the remaining 10 per cent would be used for the operation and maintenance of the project.

India's first 'Hydrogen Train' to run from Jind

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will flag-off country's first hydrogen train today

The history of Indian Railways is not merely a story of expanding tracks, but a documented journey of continuous technological progress and innovation. This journey, which began with steam engines, has passed through the stages of diesel and electricity, and is now entering a new era of green energy.

On 17 July 2026, history will be created in Jind district of Haryana when Prime Minister Narendra Modi will flag-off the country's first hydrogen train. This service, starting from the Jind-Sonipat rail section, will bring together technological innovation, energy self-reliance, and environmental responsibility.

Climate change and energy security are global challenges today, making it essential to make the transport sector clean and energy-efficient. Indian Railways has also accelerated its modernisation through large-scale electrification, modern station development, and advanced safety systems. The hydrogen train is the next step in this journey.

It holds special significance that this transformation is

beginning from Haryana. The choice of the Jind-Sonipat section reflects the state's strong infrastructure and its capacity to implement projects effectively. Investments in industrial development, expansion of national highways, and civil aviation have made Haryana a natural hub for projects of national importance.

Haryana Shaping New Dimensions of Development

Under the visionary leadership of PM Modi and the coordinated efforts of the double-engine government, unprecedented work is taking place in Haryana in infrastructure, health, education, and transport. On 17 July, the Prime Minister will inaugurate and lay the foundation for projects worth over Rs 14,700 crore, including the Jind-Sonipat hydrogen train, the Kurukshetra elevated railway track, medical colleges in Bhiwani and Narnaul, the Delhi-Ambala-Katra highway, and the Ambala-Kala Amb and Jind-Gohana national highways. Along with this, the foundation stone will also be laid for the Sikh Museum in Kurukshetra and the Hansi-Barwala highway, giving new direction to the state's cultural



and infrastructural development. These projects will form a strong foundation for Haryana's economic growth, healthcare services, transport, investment, and employment, and will help realise the resolve of a 'Viksit Bharat'.

Hydrogen Train — The Future of Rail Technology

Hydrogen technology is based on a fuel cell system, in which a chemical reaction between stored hydrogen and atmospheric oxygen generates electrical energy, releasing only water and heat as by-products and no polluting gases. This is especially effective for rail routes where full electrification is not practical, and it helps reduce dependence on fossil fuels.

Indian Railways has also brought about extensive

changes in operations, safety, and energy management. Rapid electrification, indigenous safety systems, and the growing use of renewable energy have made the railways more modern and environmentally responsible. The hydrogen train is the next step in this direction, one that will help strengthen energy security and reduce dependence on imported fuel.

Germany gave global recognition to this technology by launching a commercial hydrogen passenger train service, and following this, several countries including China have accelerated its development and testing. India's move shows that the country is not merely following global changes but is actively participating in the development of future transport systems. The Jind-Sonipat service will stand as a strong example of Indian engineering capability and commitment to clean energy.

In line with the National Green Hydrogen Mission, the integration of hydrogen technology into rail transport will accelerate the energy transition and, in the future, offer new options for rail routes where conven-

tional electrification is not feasible. Haryana becoming the first stop of this historic initiative is proof of the state's developed infrastructure and effective implementation capacity.

When this train sets out on its first journey on 17 July, it will not merely be a means of carrying passengers to their destination, but a symbol of Indian Railways' new vision, in which technological innovation and environmental sensitivity advance together. This journey will give new direction to the development of the railways in the years ahead and will be remembered as an important milestone giving new momentum to the resolve of a green, modern, and Atmanirbhar Bharat.

Prime Minister's visionary thinking has made Haryana the first witness to the country's largest green technology initiative, and this is a matter of great pride for me. I believe it is the result of the PM's leadership that Haryana today stands among the leading states in the country in development, innovation, and self-reliance.

- Nayab Singh Saini
Haryana Chief Minister

Nation Briefs

ECR: BIHAR'S SHIVNARAYANPUR RAILWAY STATION READY WITH A NEW LOOK

HAJIPUR: Underscoring Indian Railways' commitment to developing modern, accessible, and passenger-centric railway stations across the country, the Shivanarayanpur railway station in Bihar



has undergone comprehensive redevelopment under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme (ABSS). The redeveloped station integrates modern passenger amenities with the region's cultural identity; it will play a pivotal role in accelerating regional development while ensuring a safe, convenient, and comfortable travel experience.

NFR: REDEVELOPED RAILWAY STATIONS BRINGS NEW PROSPECTS

MALIGAON: The redevelopment of Majbat Railway Station in Assam, Jalpaiguri Road & Haldibari Railway stations in West Bengal under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme has ushered in a new era of convenience, pride and development for the people living in and around these regions. Residents, passengers, traders and daily commuters have expressed immense happiness over the transformation of their respective stations, which have long served as important lifelines for the surrounding areas.





EDITORIAL

RESPONSIBLE
GLOBALISATION

For decades, trade policy was largely viewed through the lens of tariffs, quotas and market access. Today, however, the rules of global commerce are being rewritten around values as much as value chains. Labour rights, environmental standards, sustainability and supply-chain transparency have become central to international trade negotiations. India's decision to amend its Foreign Trade Policy to empower the government to prohibit imports produced through forced labour reflects this changing reality. While the immediate trigger may have been mounting international scrutiny, including the United States Trade Representative's (USTR) ongoing Section 301 investigation covering India and dozens of other economies, the reform carries significance that extends well beyond a single trade dispute. It closes an important policy gap, aligns India more closely with emerging global norms and signals that the country intends to compete not merely on cost but also on credibility. In an era where responsible production increasingly influences market access, ethical trade is no longer a matter of image alone; it is becoming an economic necessity.

Forced labour remains one of the gravest contradictions of the modern global economy. The International Labour Organisation estimates that nearly 28 million people worldwide continue to work under conditions involving coercion, threats or the absence of genuine consent. Such exploitation cuts across agriculture, mining, manufacturing, construction and services, often hidden within complex international supply chains. Its consequences extend far beyond the workers directly affected. Products manufactured through forced labour artificially reduce production costs, distort competition and disadvantage businesses that comply with labour laws and ethical standards. Consequently, governments are no longer treating forced labour solely as a human rights concern. It has increasingly become a trade issue because goods produced under exploitative conditions undermine fair competition in global markets. Countries including the United States, Canada and Mexico already prohibit imports linked to forced labour, while the European Union has introduced its own regulatory framework to identify and remove such products from its market. India could not remain outside this evolving international architecture if it wishes to strengthen its position as a trusted global manufacturing and export hub.

The newly introduced provision in India's Foreign Trade Policy should therefore be viewed as an enabling mechanism rather than an immediate prohibition. It authorises the government to investigate complaints, seek information and, where appropriate, prohibit the import of specific products found to have been produced wholly or partly through forced labour. This is an important distinction. The notification does not impose blanket restrictions or create arbitrary barriers to trade. Instead, it establishes a legal framework that allows evidence-based action when necessary. Until now, India prohibited forced labour within its own constitutional and legal framework but lacked an explicit trade policy instrument to prevent imports produced through forced labour abroad. The amendment fills that institutional gap. Equally important, it enhances India's credibility during ongoing trade negotiations with multiple partners by demonstrating that its regulatory framework is evolving alongside international expectations. As India seeks to attract investment through initiatives such as Make in India and positions itself as an alternative manufacturing destination amid global supply-chain diversification, regulatory credibility has become a strategic economic asset.

At the same time, the amendment should not be interpreted as a complete solution to India's trade challenges with the United States. The USTR's Section 301 investigation covers sixty economies and alleges that the absence of effective import prohibitions on forced labour products places American businesses at a competitive disadvantage. India has rightly argued that the investigation fails to establish a sufficient causal connection between its domestic framework and any measurable injury to US commerce. Critics have also questioned whether Washington's proposal to impose country-wide tariffs, rather than targeting specific products supported by concrete evidence, risks transforming legitimate labour concerns into a new form of protectionism. Human rights cannot become a convenient instrument for selective trade restrictions or geopolitical leverage. If labour standards are to command global legitimacy, they must be applied consistently, transparently and without discrimination. Otherwise, ethical trade risks becoming another arena for commercial rivalry rather than genuine international cooperation. India is therefore justified in strengthening its own regulatory framework while continuing to contest measures that appear disproportionate or insufficiently evidence-based.

Ultimately, India's latest policy amendment represents a recognition that competitiveness in the twenty-first century depends upon trust as much as efficiency. Global buyers increasingly seek assurance that products entering their markets are free from exploitation, environmental harm and opaque sourcing practices. Consumers, investors and multinational companies now evaluate supply chains through ethical as well as commercial criteria. India's long-term advantage will therefore lie not in resisting these expectations but in shaping them through robust domestic institutions, transparent enforcement and credible compliance mechanisms. The challenge ahead is to ensure that the new framework remains practical, predictable and fair, protecting legitimate trade while effectively addressing genuine cases of forced labour. If implemented with integrity, the reform will strengthen India's reputation as a responsible trading nation, improve confidence in its manufacturing ecosystem and reinforce its standing in future trade negotiations. Ethical commerce and economic growth need not exist in opposition. Properly designed, they can reinforce one another, allowing India to build an export economy that is not only globally competitive but also grounded in fairness, dignity and the rule of law.

NEXUS
OF GOOD



ANIL SWARUP

THE WRITER IS
AN AUTHOR AND
A FORMER
CIVIL SERVANT

The Mahila Kisan Chaupal bridges critical gaps in rural agriculture by bringing government departments, technical knowledge and women farmers onto a common platform

Empowering India's Women Farmers

The Mahila Kisan Chaupal is giving women farmers knowledge, recognition and leadership, strengthening climate-resilient agriculture across Sidhi's rural communities today

In the remote tribal region of Podi in Kusmi block of Madhya Pradesh's Sidhi district, a quiet but powerful transformation is taking shape. It is not being driven by large machines, corporate investments or distant policy documents alone. It is being led by rural women who sow, nurture, harvest, preserve seeds, manage livestock, support households and sustain village economies, yet often remain invisible in formal narratives of agricultural development.

Against this background, the district administration of Sidhi has initiated a meaningful and timely intervention: the "Mahila Kisan Chaupal", or Women Farmers' Dialogue. Organised under the broader vision of the "Farmer Welfare Year", the Chaupal has created a participatory platform where women farmers can speak, learn, demonstrate, exchange knowledge and be recognised as central actors in agriculture and rural development.

Sidhi is a district where agriculture is not only an occupation; it is the backbone of social and economic life. In several tribal and rural areas of the district, women contribute significantly to almost every stage of farming, from seed selection, sowing and weeding to harvesting, storage, processing and marketing. It is estimated that women contribute to more than 60 per cent of agricultural activities in the region. Despite this, their role has traditionally remained under-recognised. Land titles are often in the names of men, agricultural decisions are frequently seen as a male domain, and women's labour is treated as an extension of household responsibility rather than an economic contribution.

This invisibility creates several problems. Women farmers often have limited access to formal training, new technologies, government schemes, market linkages, credit support and platforms where they can share their knowledge. They may possess deep practical wisdom about seeds, soil, water, forests and traditional farming practices, but this knowledge rarely receives institutional recognition. As a result, agricultural planning sometimes misses the very people who are most closely connected with daily farming operations. The Mahila Kisan Chaupal was designed to address this gap precisely.

The Chaupal solves a critical problem: it brings women farmers from the margins of agricultural discussion to the centre of decision-making and learning. Instead of treating them only as beneficiaries, it recognises them as knowledge-holders, innovators and leaders of sustainable agriculture. It also creates a bridge between women farmers and the administration,



Women contribute over 60% of agricultural work in many parts of Sidhi but have long remained under-recognised

enabling direct communication on issues such as natural farming, organic inputs, dairy, fisheries, government schemes, seed preservation and market access.

An event organised under the programme witnessed enthusiastic participation from tribal women farmers, many of whom are already practising natural and organic farming in their own fields. These women are not merely adopting a government message; they are actively shaping a local model of low-cost, climate-sensitive and community-driven agriculture. Their practices reduce dependence on chemical fertilisers and costly external inputs, improve soil health, conserve water and strengthen household food security. In a region where small and marginal farmers face rising input costs and climate uncertainty, these practices carry immense significance.

One of the most inspiring moments of the event came when a woman farmer, Ritu Singh, presented a motivational folk song in the local dialect. Through music, she explained the benefits of natural farming and zero-budget farming practices using jaggery, cow dung, cow urine and locally available natural resources. Her song was more than a cultural expression; it was agricultural extension in the language of the people. It translated technical ideas into familiar idioms and demonstrated that communication becomes more powerful when it emerges from within the community.

This approach solves another major problem in rural development: the gap between technical knowledge and local understanding. Government advisories and training manuals often fail to reach rural communities in a form that is relatable. The Chaupal model, by allowing local women to communicate through

songs, examples and lived experience, makes knowledge accessible, memorable and trustworthy.

The event also showcased remarkable community-driven innovation. Rajmati Singh, a member of the Gram Sudhar Samiti, shared the success of a community seed bank operating in Medra village for the past six years. This seed bank preserves 123 varieties of indigenous organic seeds. It promotes the use of organic fertilisers such as Jeevamrit and encourages farmers to move away from chemical dependency. The model is simple but powerful: farmers borrow seeds and return one-and-a-half times the quantity after harvest. This ensures that the seed reserves continue to grow and remain available to the community.

The seed bank addresses one of the most serious challenges faced by small farmers: dependence on external seed markets. When local seeds disappear, farmers become dependent on purchased seeds, which increases input costs and reduces local resilience. Community seed banks preserve biodiversity, protect traditional varieties and give farmers greater control over their own agriculture. When led by women, such initiatives also strengthen their status within the village economy.

Similarly, Yashoda Singh has formed 12 self-help groups across five villages and is spreading awareness about organic farming and collective action. Her work shows how women's groups can become powerful institutions of rural change. Self-help groups are not only financial groups; they can become platforms for training, awareness, production, aggregation, processing and marketing. When women farmers organise collectively, they gain bargaining power, confidence and access

to opportunities that may not be available individually.

During the programme, women farmers were also provided with moong seeds, and those demonstrating exceptional agricultural innovation were honoured by local representatives and district officials. This recognition matters deeply. In rural societies, public honour can change perceptions. When women farmers are felicitated on a public platform, their work gains legitimacy. Families, communities and institutions begin to see them not merely as helpers in farming, but as farmers in their own right.

The Mahila Kisan Chaupal also contributes to solving the problem of fragmented service delivery. Agriculture, horticulture, animal husbandry, fisheries, rural livelihoods, women and child development, tribal welfare and market-related schemes often operate through separate channels. A village woman may not know which department to approach for which benefit. A Chaupal brings multiple streams of information to one accessible space. It allows departments to listen directly to beneficiaries and enables women farmers to understand available schemes in a practical manner.

The initiative also aligns with the broader idea of women-led development. For a long time, development discourse focused on welfare for women. The new approach must go further: women should become leaders of growth, innovation and community transformation. In Sidhi, the Mahila Kisan Chaupal is doing exactly that. It recognises that rural women are not passive recipients of support; they are active builders of food security, ecological balance and local economic resilience.

The initiative also has the potential to support climate-resilient agriculture. Natural farming, indigenous seeds, improved soil health, water conservation and reduced chemical use are all important for adapting to climate variability.

The Mahila Kisan Chaupal in Sidhi demonstrates how local governance, when combined with community participation and women-led innovation, can create transformative change. It addresses multiple problems at once: the invisibility of women's agricultural labour, lack of access to knowledge and government schemes, dependence on costly inputs, erosion of traditional seed systems, weak market linkages and limited recognition of women as farmers.

The model put in place in Sidhi is a wonderful example of the Nexus of Good and can be scaled through public-private partnerships.

Views expressed are personal

TIMELESS
ICONS



COL RANJIT SINGH

THE WRITER IS A
MILITARY VETERAN
AND FORMER JOINT
SECRETARY, NHRC,
GOVT OF INDIA

100 years after his martyrdom, his ideals remain vital to Bharat's democratic and pluralistic consciousness

A Legacy Beyond Time

A century after his martyrdom, Sardar Teja Singh Samundri remains an enduring symbol of peaceful resistance, religious freedom, democratic leadership and selfless national service

A century after his martyrdom, Sardar Teja Singh Samundri continues to shine as a symbol of courage, sacrifice, and unwavering commitment to justice. His life represents the finest traditions of Bharat's democratic spirit, a rare combination of moral leadership, peaceful resistance, protection of heritage and selfless service to society. A freedom fighter, institution builder and defender of religious liberty, he dedicated his life to principles that remain central to the nation. His legacy lives not only in the institutions he helped shape but also in the values he defended and the heritage he preserved. Perhaps no tribute reflects his stature more eloquently than the Teja Singh Samundri Hall within the sacred precincts of Sri Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple), Amritsar, the only major cultural and administrative building in the Golden Temple complex named after an individual. This unique honour reflects the extraordinary respect he commands in Sikh history. Yet his contribution extends far beyond the Sikh community. He belongs to the national pantheon of leaders who strengthened India's democratic consciousness long before Independence. At a time when colonial rule sought to interfere with religious institutions and suppress community rights, Teja Singh Samundri emerged as a fearless yet deeply humane leader who believed that justice could be achieved through peaceful struggle, moral courage and collective action. He played a defining role in the historic Gurdwara Reform Movement, inspiring thousands to protect Sikh shrines through



His defence of pluralism, minority rights and religious liberty anticipated the constitutional values that independent India would later formally embrace

democratic and accountable management. His leadership during the agitation to safeguard the boundary wall of Gurdwara Rakab Ganj Sahib in Delhi became a landmark moment in India's struggle for religious freedom. When the British administration demolished part of the historic wall during the construction of New Delhi, he led a disciplined, non-violent movement that compelled the colonial government to respect the sanctity of religious heritage. It was not merely a struggle to preserve a wall; it was a defence of faith, dignity and the fundamental right of every commu-

nity to protect its sacred places. His vision also embraced the power of ideas and public opinion. Through his association with the early Akali movement that supported the establishment of the Hindustan Times, he recognised that a free and responsible press was essential for a vibrant democracy. Even imprisonment could not weaken his resolve. Until his martyrdom in Lahore Central Jail on 17 July 1926, he remained steadfast in his commitment to truth, justice and selfless public service, leaving behind a legacy that transcends religion, region and politics.

What distinguishes Sardar Teja Singh Samundri is that he sought neither power nor personal recognition but dedicated his entire life to principles that continue to define a democratic society. Long before the Constitution guaranteed freedom of religion, equality before the law and democratic governance, he was already defending those ideals through action. He understood that preserving religious heritage was inseparable from protecting human dignity and that safeguarding minority rights strengthened national unity. His leadership was marked by humility, integrity and moral authority. He united farmers, workers, scholars and ordinary citizens around a common cause, demonstrating that peaceful public mobilisation could challenge even the might of an empire. His work preserved not only historic gurdwaras but also the identity, traditions and collective memory of a community whose contribution to Bharat's civilisation is immense. In today's world, where societies increasingly face division and intolerance, his life offers a powerful lesson. He showed that diversity is a source of strength, that protecting the rights of one community reinforces the freedoms of all, and that genuine patriotism is measured through service, sacrifice and justice. His vision of inclusive leadership anticipated many of the democratic values that independent India would later embrace. For these reasons, he deserves recognition not merely as a Sikh icon but as one of the foremost champions of pluralism, constitutional values and democratic evolution.

As Bharat commemorates one hundred years since the martyrdom of this extraordinary son of the soil, Sardar Teja Singh Samundri's legacy deserves to inspire generations beyond the boundaries of community and region. His life reminds us that nations are strengthened not only by political leaders and institutions but also by individuals who stand firm for justice, protect heritage and uphold human dignity. Young Indians should know that the freedoms and democratic values they cherish today were shaped by countless selfless patriots who sacrificed personal comfort for larger ideals. Teja Singh Samundri's journey teaches that courage must be guided by compassion, leadership by integrity and faith by respect for others. In a world searching for examples of ethical public leadership, his life offers a timeless message, that peaceful resistance can overcome oppression, diversity can become a source of unity, and service to society is the highest form of patriotism. Remembering him is therefore not merely an act of historical recognition; it is a reaffirmation of the values that bind Bharat together as a diverse, democratic and compassionate nation. One hundred years after his martyrdom, Sardar Teja Singh Samundri remains a beacon of hope and an enduring symbol of courage, harmony and national unity. His legacy truly transcends time, reminding future generations that the greatness of a nation lies in honouring those who protected its heritage, defended its values and served humanity with unwavering dedication.

Views expressed are personal

PM SAYS DEAL WILL BOOST EXPORTS; UK ENVOY HAILS IT AS ‘GOLD STANDARD’

India-UK trade pact takes effect

On 1st day of pact, goods worth \$140 mn exported

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) came into force on Wednesday, granting duty-free access to nearly 99 per cent of Indian exports to the UK and paving the way for deeper trade, investment and services ties between the two countries.

Starting Wednesday, 99 per cent of Indian goods entering the UK and 90 per cent of UK goods entering India will either be duty-free or attract reduced tariffs. It will benefit a wide range of sectors on both sides, including automotive, manufacturing, consumer goods, creative industries, and medical technology. The agreement lowers tariffs across a range of sectors, including textiles, leather, gems and jewellery, engineering goods, marine products, pharmaceuticals and processed food, while expanding market access for services, digital trade and gov-



UK Deputy High Commissioner for Western India Harjinder Kang and others attend an event on the India-UK FTA, in Mumbai, Wednesday

ernment procurement. Alongside CETA, the Agreement on Social Security (Double Contribution Convention) exempts Indian professionals on temporary UK assignments of up to 60 months from making social security contributions in both countries, reducing costs for employees and employers.

India offered tariff concessions on 89.5 per cent of its tariff lines, covering 91 per cent of UK exports, while retaining protections for sensitive sec-

tors such as dairy, cereals, edible oils and certain manufacturing industries through phased tariff reductions and quota-based access. Prime Minister Narendra Modi described the operationalisation of the agreements as “a significant moment in the India-United Kingdom partnership.”

“With the coming into force of the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement and the Agreement on Social Security, our economic linkages

HIGHLIGHTS

- » 99% of Indian goods entering the UK and 90% of UK goods entering India will either be duty-free or attract reduced tariffs
- » It will benefit sectors, including automotive, manufacturing, consumer goods, creative industries, and medical technology, on both sides

are going to get even deeper. Together, these agreements translate our shared ambition into tangible opportunities for our people,” PM Modi said in a post on X.

He said the trade pact would provide fresh momentum to farmers, entrepreneurs and micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs), while giving several sectors stronger access to the UK market. Modi added that the agreement would deepen coopera-

tion in technology, professional services and innovation, while supporting greater mobility for skilled Indian talent. “The social security agreement will provide invaluable support to Indian professionals working temporarily in the UK and strengthen the competitiveness of Indian enterprises,” Modi said.

Meanwhile, British High Commissioner Lindy Cameron said the pact is a “new gold standard” of trade deals, and it sends a message to the rest of the world that rules-based order works. “The UK-India trade deal brings sweeping benefits for a wide range of sectors. From today, import duty on Scotch whisky has been cut from 150 per cent to 75 per cent, which should make a really significant difference to the price the consumer pays,” she said.

Cameron also said that import duties on premium UK-built cars will also begin to fall from over 110 per cent to 10 per cent, making iconic British cars cheaper for Indian consumers.

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India has exported goods worth USD 140 million to the UK at zero duty under the comprehensive economic and trade agreement (CETA), which became operational on Wednesday, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said.

He said that the agreement is a pact between two major and complementary economies. Terming the CETA as one of the “most aspirational” trade agreements by India to date, Agarwal said that over 800 technical sessions were held over 14 formal rounds of negotiations to conclude the pact.

“It is a win-win agreement between the two countries which will have a shadow across economic relations,” Agrawal said while addressing industry and exporters on the day of operationalisation of the pact.

The Department of Com-

merce, he said, will work with export promotion councils to help industrial clusters understand the benefits of the agreement. The agreement grants duty-free access to nearly 99 per cent of Indian exports from sectors such as leather, footwear, textiles, mechanical and electrical machinery, plastic, base metals, marine products and gems and jewellery.

These sectors were earlier facing import duty in the UK market in the range of 2-16 per cent. The pact includes a chapter on government procurement, which provides Indian suppliers legal access to the UK government procurement market worth around GBP 90 billion (USD 122 billion). India offers reciprocal opportunities of around USD 114 billion to the British market.

UK suppliers receive treaty-backed access to covered central government procurement in India, and firms meeting a 20 pc UK-content threshold

may qualify as Class 2 Local Suppliers.

Explaining the issue, Additional Secretary in the Department of Commerce Darpan Jain said that a number of safeguards are in the pact to protect the interests of domestic MSMEs. “India reserves the right to grant preferential treatment to its MSMEs as per its policy. So that is not affected,” he said, adding that the GP commitments are not applicable at the state level.

Even at the central government level, he said, it is not applicable across all departments, PSUs and entities.

“There are selected entities to which it is applicable,” Jain said, adding that in strategic sectors, the UK firms will not be allowed.

The fourth safeguard is that there is a minimum threshold under which UK firms can participate in government procurement contracts valued at more than Rs 5.5 crore.

RBI DATA

‘India logs \$2.8 bn current account surplus in Apr-May’

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: India recorded a current account surplus of USD 2.8 billion during April-May 2026, compared with a deficit of USD 4.1 billion in the corresponding period last year, mainly aided by higher inward remittances from abroad and a rise in services exports, RBI data showed on Wednesday.

However, the country’s overall balance of payments registered a deficit of USD 11 billion during the first two months of the current fiscal year, compared to a surplus of USD 5 billion in the same period last year, according to the data. The merchandise trade deficit widened to USD 55.9 billion during the first two months of 2026-27 from USD 49.7 billion during April-May last fiscal year.

Imports rose to USD 146.5 billion during the period under review from USD 127.1 billion, while exports increased to USD 90.7 billion from USD 77.4 billion.

According to the Reserve Bank’s preliminary data on India’s balance of payments (BoP) for May, net services receipts increased to USD 34.3 billion in April-May 2026 from USD 31.7 billion in the year-ago period.

Services exports rose to USD 70.4 billion from USD 65.3 billion in April-May 2025. Net transfers, which include inward remittances from overseas, rose to USD 29.6 billion



INSIGHT

- » However, the country’s overall balance of payments registered a deficit of USD 11 billion during the first two months
- » The merchandise trade deficit widened to USD 55.9 billion during the first two months of 2026-27
- » The data also showed that the net income outgo improved marginally to USD 5.2 billion from USD 6 billion

during April-May 2026 from USD 20 billion in the year-ago period. The data also showed that the net income outgo improved marginally to USD 5.2 billion from USD 6 billion.

On the capital account side, net foreign direct investment stood at USD 6.5 billion during April-May 2026, up from USD 2.5 billion in the corresponding period last year.

On the other hand, net foreign portfolio investment recorded a larger outflow of USD 12 billion compared to USD 0.8 billion a year ago.

J&K Bank sanctions over 30K loans under Mission YUVA

SRINAGAR: J&K Bank has crossed the milestone of sanctioning more than 30,000 loans under the Jammu & Kashmir government’s flagship employment initiative, Mission YUVA, reaffirming its commitment to promoting entrepreneurship and self-employment in the Union Territory.

The bank has sanctioned 30,063 loans under the scheme and disbursed funds in over 26,580 cases, reflecting its sustained efforts to convert entrepreneurial aspirations into viable enterprises.

Congratulating the staff on the achievement, J&K Bank Managing Director and CEO Amitava Chatterjee described the milestone as a proud moment and credited the bank’s employees for their dedication and hard work.

He said that the bank remains committed to supporting the government’s vision and achieving all assigned targets within the stipulated timelines while ensuring timely financial assistance to deserving entrepreneurs.

MPOST

Rupee extends fall for 3rd day

MUMBAI: The rupee extended its slide for the third straight day and settled 9 paise lower at 96.25 against the US dollar on Wednesday, weighed down by heightened tensions in West Asia and a rise in global crude oil prices.

However, positive sentiments in the domestic equity markets and a weaker greenback prevented a sharper decline in the local unit. At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 96.12 and traded in the range of 96.04-96.35 during the session. It settled at 96.25, down 9 paise from its previous close.

The rupee depreciated 48 paise to close at 96.16 against the US dollar on Tuesday, a day after losing 30 paise.

The dollar index, which gauges the greenback’s strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 100.78, down 0.14 per cent.

MPOST

MPOST BUREAU

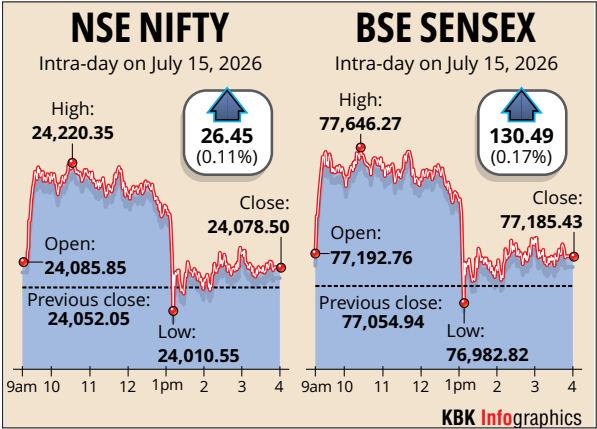
MUMBAI: Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty recovered on Wednesday following buying in bank stocks and softer-than-expected US inflation data, reinforcing expectations that the Federal Reserve may adopt a less aggressive monetary policy stance in the coming months.

The 30-share BSE Sensex climbed 130.49 points, or 0.17 per cent, to settle at 77,185.43. During the day, it jumped 591.33 points, or 0.76 per cent, to 77,646.27.

The 50-share NSE Nifty went up 26.45 points, or 0.11 per cent, to end at 24,078.50.

Escalating hostilities between the US and Iran, however, kept investors’ sentiment subdued in the second half of the trade, triggering profit-taking.

From the Sensex pack, Eternal, UltraTech Cement, State Bank of India, Bajaj Finance,



InterGlobe Aviation, and Asian Paints were among the major winners. Power Grid, Larsen & Toubro, Tata Steel, and Infosys were among the laggards.

Broader markets advanced, with the BSE MidCap Select index climbing 0.59 per cent and SmallCap Select index going up by 0.42 per cent.

Among sectors, Capital Goods jumped 1.27 per cent, PSU Bank (0.92 per cent),

MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt (0.83 per cent), Consumer Durables (0.76 per cent), Consumer Discretionary (0.66 per cent), Oil & Gas (0.63 per cent) and Top 10 Banks (0.55 per cent).

Utilities, FMCG, IT, Metal, Realty and Focused IT were the laggards. A total of 2,297 stocks advanced, while 1,974 declined and 171 remained unchanged on the BSE.

‘Zinc Kaushal’ empowers more than 10K youth with skills and jobs



ing 420 through partnerships with NABARD, JK Cement, YES Foundation and Bajaj Finserv. The programme has recorded

an 83 per cent placement rate and an average salary increase of 16 per cent for its trainees. Alumni are currently employed

Hindustan Zinc’s programme has focused on building a skilled workforce, with women accounting for 45 per cent of the trainees

with companies such as Tata Consultancy Services, Foxconn, Honda, Marella Cruises and GMR Group.

One of the programme’s success stories is Deepika, a resident of Bhamniya Khet village near Udaipur. After joining Zinc Kaushal’s Food and Beverage Services course, she secured a job with Marella Cruises in Spain, marking a remarkable journey from a rural background to an international hospitality career.

Another beneficiary, Wasif, who was born deaf, joined the hospitality training programme and began his career with Ramada before becoming a Guest Service Associate at Taj Aravali. He now mentors other

hearing-impaired youth.

A key milestone during the year was the 100 per cent placement of a special batch of deaf and mute trainees at hospitality brands including Taj Fateh Prakash, Radisson Blu and The Fern Residency.

Implemented in partnership with Ambuja Foundation and Tata Strive, Zinc Kaushal operates through six skilling centres in Rajasthan and has received four district-level awards from the Rajasthan government for its contribution to enhancing youth employability.

MPOST

IN A SWORN AFFIDAVIT

Adani denies ‘any deal’ linked to dismissal of US criminal case

NEW DELHI: Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani has denied under oath that there was any promise, agreement or deal behind the US Department of Justice’s move to dismiss a criminal indictment against him, saying, in a sworn affidavit, that he was unaware of any exchange connected to the decision.

The affidavit was filed in response to a July 8 order by the US District Court for the Eastern District of New York asking Adani to state under oath whether he was aware of any promise, offer or agreement related to the dismissal of the indictment.

Adani said he was not aware of “anything promised, offered, sought, received, agreed to, or accepted” by anyone in connection with the dismissal, and denied knowledge of any agreement involving an exchange of anything of value for dropping the criminal charges.

The Justice Department had moved to dismiss charges filed in 2024 under the Biden administration, accusing Adani and seven others of participating

in a scheme to pay about USD 250 million in bribes to Indian officials to secure power supply contracts and misleading investors while raising capital in US markets.

Adani has denied the allegations.

Addressing speculation over Adani Group’s proposed US investment plans, Adani said the group’s intention to invest USD 10 billion in the United States had been publicly announced on November 13, 2024, before the indictment was unsealed.

According to the affidavit, Adani’s legal counsel, Sullivan & Cromwell LLP, held meetings with officials from the US Department of Justice (DoJ) and the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC), and submitted a white paper, expert reports and other materials.

The counsel also indicated that the proposed investment could potentially form part of a resolution if US authorities chose to consider it.

The DoJ later informed counsel that the proposed investment would not be considered in deciding whether to

seek dismissal, and Adani said the investment plan played no role in the department’s decision.

The affidavit follows a July 4 filing by the DoJ in which prosecutors rejected reports linking the dismissal of the case to investment commitments in the US, calling such claims false.

The department said the prosecution faced legal and evidentiary challenges, including that the alleged conduct was largely centred in India, involved no identified investor losses, and was already subject to investigations in India.

The DoJ also told the court that the indictment appeared to have been unsealed during the final days of the Joe Biden administration as a “name-and-shame” action, leaving the matter for the succeeding Donald Trump Administration.

The indictment, announced in November 2024, triggered a sharp sell-off in Adani Group stocks, wiping out nearly Rs 2.85 lakh crore in market capitalisation over four trading sessions and affecting millions of shareholders.

AGENCIES

VIVA LA ROJA

Spain reign supreme against France to reach first WC final since 2010

ARLINGTON: Spain's defensive prowess and swagger were just too much for an attacking trio led by France great Kylian Mbappé, and just enough to get the 2010 champions into another World Cup final.

The Spanish team managed a sixth shutout in seven games so far, winning 2-0 in the semifinals Tuesday against one of the most prolific scorers in World Cup history.

Teenager Lamine Yamal certainly was correct when he said France should fear Spain. That despite FIFA's top-ranked team being led by Mbappé — their captain with 20 goals in his 20 World Cup games before the semifinals — Ballon d'Or winner Ousmane Dembélé and Michael Olise, who has a tournament-high five assists.

"They were facing the best team in the world," Spain coach Luis de la Fuente said of his players.

Mikel Oyarzabal scored from the penalty spot after a heady play by Yamal drew a foul, and Pedro Porro added another goal to put Spain in its second World Cup final.

A day after his 19th birthday, Yamal was denied a goal on a close offside call that came soon after Porro's give-and-go with Dani Olmo in the 58th minute had put Spain up 2-0.



Spain's Pedro Porro celebrates doubling the lead against France

AP

But it was Yamal's smart play against a veteran defender that gave Spain the early lead.

"So difficult to get to this moment, but we want more," Spain midfielder Rodri said. "We want to win this World Cup."

After trying to become only the third team to reach three consecutive World Cup finals, France instead will play in the third-place game in Miami Gardens, Florida, on Saturday.

"Spain has been able to defend well," departing France coach Didier Deschamps said through a translator. "They've

8
Spain are the first European team to win eight straight knockout matches at major tournaments

closed out all the spaces and also we've made some technical mistakes. So it is difficult to

create problems when the technical level is below standard."

This win on soccer's biggest stage marked the third summer in a row that Spain beat France in a tournament semifinal match. Yamal scored in a 2-1 win in the 2024 European Championship semifinals just days before his 17th birthday, and La Roja won 5-4 in Nations League play last year.

"It's a team who loves to have control of the game, control of the ball. That's what we let them do," said Mbappé, who got none of his three shots on target.

AGENCIES

Simon stands tall

ARLINGTON: Spain goalkeeper Unai Simón sprinted off his line to beat a charging Kylian Mbappé to the ball with France desperately seeking a goal in the World Cup semifinals.

While Simón managed to get there first and head the ball away, he suddenly had the World Cup's co-scoring leader between him and the net with France forward Desire Doue trying to get control of the ball.

Even in that rare moment of chaos late in the match, the structured Spanish defense and the standout keeper again didn't allow a goal.

The latest shutout for Simón and Spain came against FIFA's top-ranked team, which had Mbappé coming into the match with 20 goals in his 20 World Cup games. "Spain has been able to defend well. I've watched all of their matches, and today they've done it very well," France coach Didier Deschamps said.

AGENCIES

GOLDEN BOOT DUEL WITH MESSI CONTINUES

Mbappe and France pick up the pieces after Spanish lesson

ARLINGTON: Kylian Mbappé had France poised for another run to the World Cup final with a team that seemingly had the offensive firepower to solve Spain's stout defence.

Instead, Les Bleus had no answers in a 2-0 semifinal loss at the home of the NFL's Dallas Cowboys on Tuesday in what is presumably coach Didier Deschamps' final appearance on soccer's biggest stage.

Deschamps, who has said this would be his last World Cup, won a title as a player in 1998 and again as a coach eight years ago in Russia before leading France to the final in 2022 in Qatar. Argentina won that championship in a penalty shootout.

"I've been lucky as a player to enjoy happy moments," Deschamps said through a translator, while also saying it wasn't yet time to discuss his future. "Today is not such a moment. But I think we must accept it without forgetting everything that we've experienced so far. But today's feeling is that I am not happy."

The disappointment reverberated from Texas across the Atlantic Ocean. A number of clashes reportedly broke out in Paris, with incidents between law enforcement and young people also reported in Lyon.



Kylian Mbappe had a below-par game

AP

0
France have yet to win a game at the World Cup finals when trailing at half-time

French media lamented that their team had been unable to reproduce the exhilarating performances it had delivered while never trailing in its first six World Cup matches.

L'Équipe, France's leading

sports newspaper, noted that Deschamps' players had been outplayed in every aspect of the game, "unable to live up to their dreams and to the hope they had inspired."

Those players didn't disagree, although Mbappé was quick to defend his coach, and said he would play hard for Deschamps in the third-place match against the Argentina-England loser on Saturday in Miami Gardens, Florida.

"Nothing changed about what Didier means to us as a French people. As a manager, as a player, he wrote an amazing story," said the France captain, who got a quick hug from his coach on the sideline after the final whistle.

AGENCIES

STRENGTH AND CONDITIONING BECOME PRIME FOCUS

Hockey teams stick to fitness ahead of WC

NEW DELHI: Strength and conditioning has emerged as the central focus as India prepares for next month's FIH Hockey World Cup, with chief coaches Craig Fulton and Sjoerd Marijne saying the ongoing national camps are aimed at ensuring the men's and women's teams peak physically for the marquee event.

The World Cup will be held in Belgium and the Netherlands from August 15 to 30, marking the first time that the men's and women's tournaments will be staged simultaneously.

“The sessions have been sharp and competitive, with everyone eager to be back together

— Craig Fulton, India men's team coach

The men's team heads into

the showpiece after an encouraging FIH Pro League campaign in Europe, where it registered wins over reigning world champions Germany, Olympic champions the Netherlands and Pakistan.

"The players have come into the camp fresh after the break and you can see it in the energy on the pitch. The sessions have been sharp and competitive," Fulton said.

Fulton said the camp has struck the right balance between physical conditioning and tactical refinement.

"We're doing strong conditioning work early in the week to build our physical base, before moving into more tactical, unit-based sessions as the week progresses," said Fulton.

The women's team, meanwhile, enters the World Cup on a high after clinching the FIH Nations Cup title with an unbeaten campaign, earning promotion to next season's Pro League.

"The players are excited and you can clearly see that energy during our training sessions," Marijne said.

AGENCIES

Eyes on Rohit, Gill as India look to finish the job

CARDIFF: Skipper Shubman Gill's fitness and Rohit Sharma's form are major concerns for India as they seek to lock a much-needed series victory over England in the second ODI here on Wednesday.

India's six-wicket win in the first match in Birmingham gave them a 1-0 lead in the three-match series, but it also highlighted some worrying aspects of the team's performance.

Batting on 80, Gill had to walk off the field in palpable pain and India would hope that it was nothing more than cramps.

A similar exit by Gill last



Shubman Gill and Rohit Sharma during the first ODI

AP

year during the first Test against South Africa at Kolkata had led to hospitalisation, rendering him unavailable for the remainder of that engagement.

So, the Men in Blue will not

want an encore as Gill's presence is imperative as leader and a tone-setting opener. While his opening partner Rohit does not carry any such fitness issues, the management will certainly

look at his batting numbers.

The Mumbai man seemed to have shelved his brazen aggression since losing captaincy, but the changed approach has not brought any bigger dividend yet.

The 'Hitman' has played 13 ODIs just as a senior member in the team since October last year, making 563 runs at an average of 46.91 with a hundred and four fifties. It's not a record to scoff at. But the current dynamics within the dressing room and the absence of the safety net of captaincy around him have made it mandatory for Rohit to deliver.

AGENCIES

Leisure



Rani Mukerji to receive honorary doctorate

She will be felicitated by Australia's La Trobe University

Rani Mukerji will be conferred an Honorary Doctor of Letters by Australia's La Trobe University in recognition of her contribution to Indian cinema and humanitarian work, the Indian Film Festival of Melbourne (IFFM) announced.

The honorary degree will be presented at a special ceremony on August 14 at Federation Square in Melbourne during the 2026 edition of the festival, which runs from August 13 to 23.

Mukerji, whose career spans nearly three decades, is known for films such as 'Black', 'No One Killed Jessica', 'Hichki', the 'Mardaani' franchise and 'Mrs Chatterjee vs Norway'.

In a statement, the festival said the recognition also acknowledges her support for causes related to women, children and marginalised communities.

"I am deeply humbled to receive this Honorary Doctor of Letters from La Trobe University. Cinema has been my greatest teacher in my life's journey and I have always believed in the power of storytelling to inspire empathy, spark

'Cinema has been my greatest teacher in my life's journey,' she says

conversations and bring about positive change," Mukerji said.

She added, "To receive this honour during the Indian Film Festival of Melbourne, which has consistently celebrated Indian cinema on a global stage, makes it even more special... I dedicate this special honour from Australia and IFFM to my motherland India and to everyone around the world whose love has empowered me to be an actor and made me live such a full life."

La Trobe University Chancellor John Brumby said Mukerji's work had gone beyond entertainment. "Rani Mukerji's remarkable body of work has transcended entertainment to spark important conversations around social justice, equality and inclusion. Her enduring impact on cinema, coupled with her unwavering commitment to humanitarian causes, makes her an exceptional recipient of this honorary doctorate," Brumby said.

IFFM festival director Mitu Bhowmick Lange described Mukerji as 'one of the finest actors of her generation'.

DIGGER

Tom takes on his most unpredictable role

OUR CORRESPONDENT

A comedy of catastrophic proportions, 'Digger' is an original film from Academy Award-winning filmmaker Alejandro G. Iñárritu.

From 'Warner Bros Pictures' and 'Legendary Pictures', the film stars Academy Award winner Tom Cruise as Digger Rockwell, an oil baron whose company may have triggered an ecological catastrophe with the potential to spark a nuclear war. As the conse-

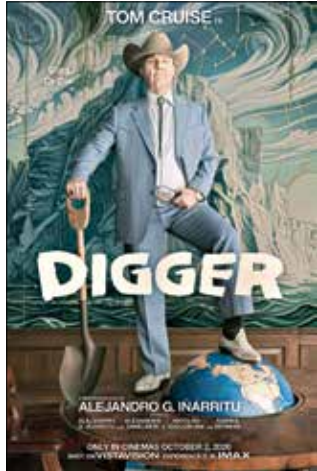
The film will be released in cinemas and IMAX across India on October 2, 2026

quences of his actions threaten to spiral beyond control, Digger, the most powerful man, embarks on a frantic mission to prove to the world that he alone can save humanity before the disaster

he unleashes destroys everything.

Cruise stars in the title role alongside Oscar winner Riz Ahmed, John Goodman, Oscar nominee Sandra Hüller, Michael Stuhlbarg and Oscar nominee Jesse Plemons. Robert John Burke, Emma D'Arcy, Burn Gorman and Sophie Wilde also star.

An Alejandro G. Iñárritu Film, 'Digger' was shot entirely in 'VistaVision' and will be released in cinemas and IMAX across India on October 2, 2026.



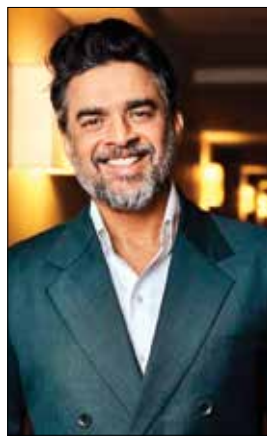
'COULD'VE FED GENERATIONS'

R Madhavan rued not getting residuals for '3 Idiots' and 'Rang De Basanti'

In Hollywood, stars continue to earn money for their past work. However, this concept is absent in Hindi cinema, making it difficult for actors to take bigger risks. In an old interview, R Madhavan had rued Bollywood for not following a similar model in India. The actor admitted that he'd have had enough money to feed generations if he were still receiving residuals from his three hit films: '3 Idiots', 'Rang De Basanti' and 'Tanu Weds Manu'.

The actor shared that stars become habituated to a particular lifestyle, but very few people understand that they shouldn't spend more than their means.

Madhavan suggested that faulty payments are the norm in the industry, but nobody bothers to challenge them because they don't have the time or resources. He added, "The moment



He suggested that faulty payments are the norm in the industry

residuals are possible, I'm sure everybody would like to jump in because then you can do the kind of work that you want."

AGENCIES

FORM NO. INC-26
Advertisement to be Published in the Newspaper
[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]

NOTICE
BEFORE REGIONAL DIRECTOR, NORTHERN REGION, NEW DELHI
In the matter of the Companies Act, 2013, Section 13(4) of Companies Act, 2013 and Rule 30(6) (a) of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014
AND
IN THE MATTER OF M/s VIKARTAN INVESTMENT PRIVATE LIMITED A COMPANY HAVING ITS REGISTERED OFFICE AT F-12, ADARSHINI PLAZA, 91, ADICHCHINI, SRI AURBINDO MARG, NEW DELHI-110017

..... (Petitioner)
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the company proposes to make application to the Central Government under section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra ordinary general meeting held on 27th Day of April, 2026 to enable the company to change its Registered office from "State of Delhi" to "State of Haryana".
Any person, whose interest likely to be affected by the said Shifting of Registered Office of the Company from the "State of Delhi" to "State of Haryana" may intimate "THE REGIONAL DIRECTOR, NORTHERN REGION, New Delhi, B-2, WING, 02nd FLOOR, PARYAVARAN BHAWAN, CGO COMPLEX, NEW DELHI-1100 03" within 21 days from the date of Publication of this notice, the nature of interest and grounds of opposition to the opposition if any, supported by an affidavit and should send the same in original to the Regional Director with a copy to the petitioner at the Registered Office of the Company as mentioned above.

By Order of the Board
For VIKARTAN INVESTMENT PRIVATE LIMITED
Sd/- MUKESH AGARWAL
(DIRECTOR)
DIN- 00251287

DATE: 11/07/2026
PLACE: NEW DELHI

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	07260309	LOWER SPRING BEAM ARRANGEMENT, MEMU	200 NOS	05.08.2026
02	07260385A	SET OF TPU RING	576 SET	12.08.2026
03	02261802	VALVE REGULATED LEAD ACID BATTERY 1100AH	107 SET	17.08.2026
04	07261583	203 MM AIR BRAKE CYLINDER WITH SLACK	1783 NOS	10.09.2026

Note:- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details.
2. No manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No.: 27/2026-2027 Dated: 15.07.2026 2441/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

FORM NO. INC-26
Advertisement to be Published in the Newspaper
[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]

NOTICE
BEFORE REGIONAL DIRECTOR, NORTHERN REGION, NEW DELHI
In the matter of the Companies Act, 2013, Section 13(4) of Companies Act, 2013 and Rule 30(6) (a) of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014
AND
IN THE MATTER OF M/s MAKAMS INDUSTRIES PRIVATE LIMITED A COMPANY HAVING ITS REGISTERED OFFICE AT F-12, ADARSHINI PLAZA, 91, ADICHCHINI, SRI AURBINDO MARG, NEW DELHI-110017

..... (Petitioner)
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the company proposes to make application to the Central Government under section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra ordinary general meeting held on 15th Day of May, 2026 to enable the company to change its Registered office from "State of Delhi" to "State of Haryana".
Any person, whose interest likely to be affected by the said Shifting of Registered Office of the Company from the "State of Delhi" to "State of Haryana" may intimate "THE REGIONAL DIRECTOR, NORTHERN REGION, New Delhi, B-2, WING, 02nd FLOOR, PARYAVARAN BHAWAN, CGO COMPLEX, NEW DELHI-1100 03" within 21 days from the date of Publication of this notice, the nature of interest and grounds of opposition to the opposition if any, supported by an affidavit and should send the same in original to the Regional Director with a copy to the petitioner at the Registered Office of the Company as mentioned above.

By Order of the Board
For MAKAMS INDUSTRIES PRIVATE LIMITED
Sd/- MUKESH AGARWAL
(DIRECTOR)
DIN- 00251287

DATE: 11/07/2026
PLACE: NEW DELHI

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय पूर्वी सिंहभूम.
जमशेदपुर
लापता: आवश्यक सूचना



गुमरादा महिला पिंकी हेन्ड्रम, उम्र-30 वर्ष।
सर्व साधारण को सूचित करना है कि गुमरादा महिला पिंकी हेन्ड्रम, उम्र-30 वर्ष, पति-शिव हेन्ड्रम, पता-गाम-काटाकाटी, पो-084 सोला, थाना-डुमरिया, जिला-पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर जो दिनांक-19.06.2026 को सुबह समय करीब 09:00 बजे घर से बैंक जाते थे कि रिप निकली है लेकिन अभी तक वापस नहीं लौटी है। जोके एक एड इनके परिवारवालों ने अपने घर से काफी खोजबीन किया परंतु कुछ पता नहीं बन सका। गुमरादा महिला का हलिया निम्न प्रकार है :- उम्र-30 वर्ष, ऊँचाई-05 फीट, रंग-गोरा, बाल-काला, बेहतर-सामान्य, पहनावे-नीले रंग का सूट एवं भूरा पैर, तथा माथा-संघाती एवं हिन्दी।
अतः आप सभी जन साधारण से अनुरोध है कि उपरोक्त गुमरादा के संबंध में किसी प्रकार की जानकारी प्राप्त होती है तो इस्की सूचना वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर के कार्यालय में निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर सूचित करें।
वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर : 0657-2431006
पुलिस अधीक्षक (गामीण), पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर : 9470199228
पुलिस उपधीक्षक, मुसाबनी : 9431706492
थाना प्रभारी, डुमरिया : 9431706524
वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर : 9431706524
PR 385049 Police(26-27)#D
POLICE HELPLINE (EMERGENCY DIAL)-112 CHILD HELPLINE-1098
WOMEN HELPLINE-1091 DOMESTIC ABUSE HELPLINE-181
CYBER CRIME HELPLINE-1930 AMBULANCE SERVICE-108

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
Jhajjar
Ompati wife of Risal Singh alias Chanderbhan
Vs.
General Public
CNR No. HRJ02-00067-2026
Next Date: 24-08-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
India
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **24-08-2026** at 10:00 am.
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mode=districtnotice&district=Jhajjar>
Sd/- **Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma**
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
dated 13-07-2026 **Jhajjar**

BSES Yamuna Power Limited, Delhi
... A joint venture with Govt. of NCT of Delhi

NOTICE INVITING TENDER Date: 16.07.2026

E-tenders are invited under the **Two-Bid System (Un-priced & Priced Bid)** for the following materials/works:

NIT & SRM RFX No.	Tender Description	Estimated Cost (₹)	Cost of EMD (₹)	Due Date / Time (Submission/Opening)
CMC/BY/26-27/RB/PM/20 [RFX No. 2200000228]	AWARDING OF THE CONTRACT OF IN-HOUSE/ONSITE REPAIRING /SERVICING OF RMU & ACB OF VARIOUS MAKE & RATING IN BYPL FOR 3 YEARS.	5.22 Crore	5.50 Lakh	05.08.2026 / 15:00 hrs (Submission) 05.08.2026 / 15:30 hrs (Opening)
CMC/BY/26-27/RB/PM/20 [RFX No. 2200000226]	CIVIL WORK REQUIRED FOR PROPOSED AUGMENTATION OF 2 NOS PTR FROM 20MVA TO 31.5 MVA AT EAST OF LONI GRID, NAND NAGRI	1.31 Crore	2.62 Lakh	05.08.2026 / 15:30 hrs (Submission) 05.08.2026 / 16:00 hrs (Opening)
CMC/BY/26-27/RB/PM/21 [RFX No. 2200000227]	CIVIL WORK REQUIRED FOR PROPOSED AUGMENTATION OF 2 NOS PTR FROM 16MVA TO 25 MVA AT DWARKAPURI GRID, DILSHAD GARDEN	1.44 Crore	2.88 Lakh	05.08.2026 / 15:30 hrs (Submission) 05.08.2026 / 16:00 hrs (Opening)
NIT No: CMC/BY/26-27/RS/PM/JYS/22 [RFX No. 2200000229]	PROVIDING CANTEEN SERVICES FOR BYPL	68.25 Lakh (Annual)	1.37 Lakh	05.08.2026 / 15:00 hrs (Submission) 05.08.2026 / 16:00 hrs (Opening)

Cost of each Tender Document: ₹1,180/- (Non-refundable)
For detailed information on the Equipment, Bill of Materials (BOM), Services, Qualifying Requirements, Terms and Conditions, Technical Specifications, and submission of Tender Documents - including any corrigendum - please visit our website at www.bsesdelhi.com → **BSES Yamuna Power Ltd → Tenders → Open Tenders**, or access our e-tendering portal at <http://srmpdportal.bsesdelhi.com/jr/jportal>.
Head (Contracts & Materials)
Regd. Off: BSES Yamuna Power Ltd, Shakti Kiran Building, Karkardooma, Delhi-110032 | CIN: U40109DL2001PLC111525
Website: www.bsesdelhi.com TEL: 011-41247111

Bandhan Bank
Regional Office: Netaji Marg, Nr. Mithakhali Six Roads, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-6. Phone: + 91-79-26421671-75

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorized Officer issued demand notice to the borrower(s) on the date mentioned against the account stated hereinafter calling upon them to repay the amount within 90 days from the date of receipt of said notice. The borrower(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular the borrower(s) that the undersigned has taken the symbolic possession of the property described herein below under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules on the date mentioned against the account. The borrower(s) in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealing with the property shall be subject to the charge of the Bank for the amounts, interest, costs and charges thereon. The borrowers' (mortgagees) attention is invited to the provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Name of borrower(s), Guarantor & Loan Account No.	Description of the property mortgaged (Secured Asset)	Date of Demand Notice	Date of Symbolic Possession Notice	O/s Amount as on Date of Demand Notice
Mr. Deepak Saini Mr. Ram Avtar Mrs. Seema Rani 90001100351679	All The Piece And Parcel Admeasuring about 2270 Sq. Ft. Bearing Property Id No. 169C 113U 161, Transfer Deed No. 531 Dated 22.04.2021 Situated At H. No. 1275, Musoma-Neelkanth Colony, Teli Majra Near Hundewala Farm, Tehsil-Jagadhri, Distt.-Yamunanagar, State-Haryana, Pin-135001. 135001. Owned By Mrs. Seema Rani W/O Sh. Ram Avtar And Same Bounded As Under: North: Public Road 22 Ft. Wide, East: Plot No. 29, West: Public Road 22 Ft. Wide, South: Plot No. 31	April 15, 2026	July 13, 2026	Rs.43,57,733.89

Place: Haryana
Date: 16/07/2026

Authorised Officer
Bandhan Bank Limited

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
OFFICE OF THE RESIDENT COMMISSIONER
NEW JHARKHAND BHAWAN
BANGLA SAHIB ROAD
NEW DELHI-110001.

1. The Notice Inviting Tender for supply of A/C taxis of various types on hire basis for use of Jharkhand Bhawan, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi published in various news papers vide PR No.381283 Cabinet (26-27)-D, Dated 03.06.2026 is hereby cancelled due to administration reasons and re-tender is invited for the same.

2. Resident Commissioner, Government of Jharkhand, Jharkhand Bhawan, New Delhi invites e-tender from reputed tenderers having minimum 4 years' experience in fleet operation in any Government Organisation (Central/State/PSU/PSE/Autonomous body) of which at least 3 years in any state bhawan located in Delhi.

e-tenders with two bid system (Technical Bid & Financial Bid) are invited from reputed bidders for supply of A/C taxis of various types on hire basis for use of Jharkhand Bhawan, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi and New Jharkhand Bhawan, Bangla Sahib Road, New Delhi

1. Date of issue of Tender notice in website- 20.07.2026
2. Bid Submission start date & time - 21.07.2026 10.00 A.M
3. Bid Submission end date & time 03.08.2026 06.00 P.M
4. Date & Time of opening of technical bid 05.08.2026 11.00 A.M
5. Date & Time of opening of financial bid To be notified after evaluation of technical bid is completed.

Details & tender document can be downloaded from website-jharkhandtenders.gov.in Sd/- (Prabhakar Ojha) Chief Administrative Officer Jharkhand Bhawan New Delhi

PR 384982 Cabinet (26-27)D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita
Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Gaurav S/o Suren R/o C-20, 1st Floor, Gali No. 06, Rajapuri, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 153/25 Dt.: 21.06.25 U/s 318(4)/316(2)/61(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita**, has been registered at **PS: Crime Branch, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said, **Gaurav** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Gaurav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Gaurav** under **FIR No. 153/25 Dt.: 21.06.25 U/s 318(4)/316(2)/61(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita**, registered at **PS: Crime Branch, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Harshita Mishra
CJM (Central), Ground Floor
Room No. 38, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/9694/Crime/2026 (Court Notice)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
INVITATION OF TENDER THROUGH E-TENDERING (E-PROCUREMENT SYSTEMS)

N.I.T. No.	Project	DLI-SNT_26_10 dated 14.07.2026
Name of work and its location	S&T work for interlocking of LC gates with TVU-10000 in section Panipat-Rohatak & Rohatak-Ashtal Bohar-Rewari (HUN) section of Delhi Division of Northern Railway.	
Approx. Cost of work	₹24,63,623.45	Bid Security Deposit ₹4,87,300/-
Completion period of work	12 Months	
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 11:30 hrs. on 05.08.2026 Opening of tender at 11:30 hrs. on 05.08.2026	
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on IREPS site www.ireps.gov.in	
No.: Project_DLI_SNT_26_10	Dated : 14.07.2026	2429/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 580 Tender Notice Date: 15/07/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tender from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No: 13/ EE(Civil) / MB-II/ Chinyalisaur / 2026-27
Name of work: Boundary Wall & Drain repair Work of CP Type Quarters at Shaktipuram Colony MB-II, Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi.
Estimated Cost: Rs. 174,690.00(excluding GST)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 17.07.2026 from 5:00 PM
Last date for submission of tender: 11.08.2026 upto 11:00 AM
For fuller & further detail, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be download from the Nigam's website "www.ujvn.com"

Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur.

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

UJVN LTD.
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No.U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No 576 TENDER NOTICE Dated 15.07.2026

The office of Executive Engineer (Test), MB-II, Dharasu Power House, Chinyalisaur invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders is given below:

Tender No: NIT-02/EE(T)/MB-II/2026-27
Name of work / Supply/Services "Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of 48 VDC, 200 AH (Planta, YKPI) Battery Bank at Dharasu Power House, Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi including Buy back of old Battery Bank."
Estimated cost: Rs. 1202855/- only (GST Inclusive).
Date of availability of bid document on website: 15.07.2026 from 16:00 Hr
Last date for submission of tender: 08.08.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvn.com"

Executive Engineer (Test)

"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in
Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010
Hue And Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

Police Station Hiranagar vide office letter no. 683/5-1/PSH dated 26-06-2026 has intimated that the accused namely Dimple Kumar S/O Chajju Ram R/O Ward No. 13 Hiranagar Tehsil Hiranagar District Kathua has been kidnapped the minor girl and evading his arrest in Case FIR No. 65/2026 U/S 137(2)/332(c)/115(2) BNS of P/S Kathua, since the commission of crime.

During the investigation of said case, best efforts are made by concerned I/O to locate/arrest said accused person which has yielded no result and accused person is still at large.

As such, description roll/photograph of wanted accused is being circulated with the appeal that anybody having information about his whereabouts may inform us on below given Phone Numbers/E-mail ID. The identity of the informer will be kept secret and he will also be rewarded suitably. Anybody found providing shelter to the accused person or concealing his presence will also be booked:-

Description Roll:-

- Name Dimple Kumar
- Parentage Chajju Ram
- Address Ward No. 13 Hiranagar
- Tehsil Hiranagar
- District Kathua
- Police Station Hiranagar
- Height 5 Feet 4 Inch
- Age 23 years
- Complexion Wheatish
- Face Oval

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpkathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311 (Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Hiranagar – 01922-27422/9103007511

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua

DIP No:DIP /J-5850/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Gaurav Sharma S/o Suraj R/o 1/1557, 2nd Floor, L/H Site West, Rohtash Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **DD No. 68, Dt. 08.02.2024, U/S 40(A) Delhi Excise Act, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gaurav Sharma** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gaurav Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Gaurav Sharma** the said accused of **DD No. 68, Dt. 08.02.2024, U/S 40(A) Delhi Excise Act, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Sanghmitra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
DP/9663/SHD/2026 Room No.-54, 2nd Floor, Shahdara Distt., (Court Matter) Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
E-TENDER NOTICE No. SG-664-09-Sig-2026-27
E-TENDER IS INVITED ON BEHALF OF THE PRESIDENT OF INDIA FOR THE UNDER MENTIONED WORKS.

SLNo.: 1. Name of the work: Provision of Essential Spare parts and items related to interlocked gate in DHN Division. SLNo.: 2. Approx. Cost of the work: ₹ 5,12,47,162.48 (Approx.) SLNo.: 3. Earnest Money: ₹ 10,25,000.00 SLNo.: 4. Date & time for closing of tender: 04.08.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. SLNo.: 5. Any E-Tenders which is sent by Post / Courier / FAX or self, Manual proposals although the letter is on firm's letter pad or received in time will not be accepted. The above E-Tenders, E-Tendering document along with full information is available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in> Note :- Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> atleast 10 days before last date of dosing for latest corrigendum / corrections etc. in response to this E-tender.

Sr. D.S.Te
East Central Railway, Dhanbad
PR/0552/DHN/S&T/126-27/36

EASTERN RAILWAY
Tender No. Com-MLDT-CashPickUp-26, dated 11.07.2026. e-tender is invited by Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager, Eastern Railway, Malda, Malda Office Building, P.O.-Jhaljhalla, District : Malda, PIN-732102 (West Bengal) for the contract of "Pick up of Cash and Instruments from 65 stations/locations of Malda Division, for a period of two years." Tenderers are to bid online in 02 packet system through the below mentioned website. No tender document in hard copy will be sold against this tender no. for the following work : **Name of Work with Location : Pick up of Cash and Instruments from 65 stations/locations of Malda Division, for a period of two years.**
Tender Value for (02) two year : ₹ 3,33,36,644.62. **Earnest Money :** ₹ 6,66,700/- **Date & time for submission of e-Tender :** Upto 15.30 hrs of 03.08.2026. **Website Particulars & Notice Board :** www.ireps.gov.in Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, Malda Division, Eastern Railway.
MLD-129/2026-27
Tender Notice is also available at websites : www.ee.inrailways.gov.in / www.ireps.gov.in
Follow us at : [@EasternRailway](https://x.com/EasternRailway) [@easternrailwayheadquarter](https://www.facebook.com/easternrailwayheadquarter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice

Deputy Chief Engineer (Construction), Planning, N.C. Railway, Prayagraj for and on behalf of the President of India invites online open E-Tenders for Project General Management Services (PGMS) (Single Stage) (Two Packets System) for the following works:

E-Tender No.: CEN-HQ-2026-27-01 **Approx. Cost:** Rs. 227.39 Crore

Description of work: Electrical/G work for :- Electrical/G work for : Improvement of emergency lighting system at station over the Jhansi Division.

Bid Security: ₹ 93,300/- only **Completion Period:** 06 months

Closing Date of Tender: 31.07.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.)

Tenderer will submit the tender online upto 31.07.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.). Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railway website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. 1608/26 (A)

[@CPRONCR](https://x.com/CPRONCR) www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
L. No.: JHS-ELG-W-T-06-2026-27 Date: 07.07.2026

TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of President of India, the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (Gen) North Central Railway, Jhansi invites open tenders through online (E- Tendering) for the following work :-

Tender No.:	JHS-ELG-W-T-06-2026-27	Tender value:	₹ 1,24,94,774/- only
Description of work: Electrical/G work for :-	Electrical/G work for : Improvement of emergency lighting system at station over the Jhansi Division.		
Bid Security:	₹ 93,300/- only	Completion Period:	06 months
Closing Date of Tender:	31.07.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.)		

Tenderer will submit the tender online upto 31.07.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.). Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railway website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. 1608/26 (A)

[@CPRONCR](https://x.com/CPRONCR) www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Manoj Kumar S/o Jagdish Chander R/o H. No. 456, Sec-17, Kheri Kalan (113), Faridabad, Haryana-121002** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT Case No. 6087/2020 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Manoj Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Manoj Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Manoj Kumar** in **CT Case No. 6087/2020 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.

By order
Ms. Shruti Sharma-I
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI ACT)-02
South-East,
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/9612/SE/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. 5520262027 Date : 13.07.2026

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering) North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India invites the following E-Tender on prescribed form for the following works up to 13:30 hrs On 05.08.2026 The details of the tenders are as under:

Tender No. :	121	Approx. Cost of Work (Rs.) :	Rs. 2,25,37,813.71
Name of Work :	Provision of supply, installation & commissioning-operation of STP for waste/sewage water recycling at TMS and other associated work at MDDT/CNB, ELS/CNB and TMS/CNB under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB.		
Earnest money : (Rs.) :	Rs. 4,50,800.00	Completion Period :	39 Months
Date of Opening of tender :	05.08.2026		
Similar work for Eligibility Criteria :	Supply installation Testing, commissioning of STP/ETP		
Note :	1. Tender on line can be submitted upto 13:30 hrs. on 05.08.2026 2. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. 05.08.2026		1604/26 (C)
			@CPRONCR

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE FOR THE SUPPLY OF STORES NO. E-04/2026.
Firms are requested to Login to <http://ireps.gov.in/login->E-Tender-goods&services> (new) and quote against the following tenders. Manual Quotations will not be entertained for these tenders. **Closing time for the tender is 14.30 hrs.**

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description of Stores	Qty.	Due Date
1	6126527	INSULATING PLATE MATERIAL NYLON 66 (NATURAL COLOUR).	AS PER TENDER	12/08/2026

Please note that only online quotations submitted through IREPS portal will be accepted and the offers are to be digitally signed.

The following e-Bid has been published in GeM Website.
Firms are requested to login to www.gem.gov.in and quote against the following e-bid. Manual quotations will not be entertained.

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Due Date
2	GEM/2026/B/7712176	RATCHET HANDLE AS PER IS 7975	9959 Nos.	10/08/2026

Senior Materials Manager, Signal Stores Depot, Southern Railway, Podanur

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
T. Notice No.: 230-Elect/TRD/PRY/JE-Tender Notice/2026/645 Date 14.07.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRDN.C.Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T. No.:	230-TRD- WC-1034-2026	Completion Period:	12 Months
Description of work:	Replacement of old OHE masts infringing signal sightlings in the Prayagraj Division		
Advertised value:	3.52,61,693.64	Bid Security:	7,05,200.00
Bidding system :	Single Packet	Tender Closing date & Time:	04.08.2026 & 14:00 Hrs
Tender Opening date & Time	04.08.2026 & 15:00 Hrs		
Note:-	1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS		



AROUND THE WORLD

» Dr Hussein Ali Mwinyi, President of Zanzibar, to grace the 63rd convocation of IIT Madras on July 17

» ICAI renews MRA with CPA Australia to boost global mobility for accountants

» Karnataka to introduce AI education from Class 6

» Now Anthropic has launched free Claude AI for teachers



BUZZER ROUND

Q) WHICH COUNTRY HAS PLAYED IN THE MOST WORLD CUP FINALS IN HISTORY?

Send us your replies to careersmp22@gmail.com. We shall publish the names of the first 3 correct entries in next week's edition

Answer to our July 9 edition question: **Lionel Messi**

Correct answers were sent by: **Kritika Ojha, Nirmal Nandy, Apratim Das**



NEWS & VIEWS

The Illinois Institute of Technology (Illinois Tech) has received the UGC Letter of Approval (LoA) to establish its Mumbai campus. With this approval, the US-based technology-focused research university is set to commence academic operations and welcome its inaugural batch of students in September 2026. Applications for the Fall 2026 intake are now open.

Only about 52 per cent of NEET UG 2026 candidates have submitted their bank account details to receive a refund of their examination fee, according to the National Testing Agency (NTA). As of July 14, 2026, a total of 11,46,401 candidates had shared their bank account details, and the agency has started processing refunds.

HOW FOREIGN LANGUAGES ARE OPENING GLOBAL DOORS

From German and Korean to French and Japanese, a growing number of Indian students are learning foreign languages for scholarships, study abroad and global careers

KANZA WAJAHAT

Rashika Kaur, a third-year BSc student at a reputed college in Kolkata, aspires to study medicine in Russia. Although most Russian medical schools offer English-language programmes for international students, a basic understanding of Russian is highly recommended, especially during practical training. For more than a year now, she has been taking Russian language classes to prepare for her academic journey abroad. As education becomes increasingly globalised and inclusive, the importance of learning a foreign language is gaining momentum. Learning a foreign language boosts personal, professional, and cognitive growth. Today, many young Indians view foreign languages as a bridge to scholarships, student exchange programmes, and higher education opportunities overseas.

One of the biggest drivers behind this trend is the growing connection between language proficiency and scholarship programmes offered by foreign countries. Germany's public universities, for instance, are known for their affordable education, while several scholarship programmes provide stipends that cover living expenses. This has become a major



factor motivating students to learn German. For an Indian engineering student or economics graduate, learning German is no longer a niche interest; it is a practical step towards pursuing a master's degree in Europe without the burden of high tuition fees.

South Korea has generated similar enthusiasm through government-sponsored initiatives such as the Global Korea Scholarship (GKS), which offers tuition support, accommodation, living allowances, and intensive

language training. The benefits of learning a foreign language extend well beyond the classroom. Once students arrive in a new country, language becomes an essential part of their everyday lives. Those who are fluent in German, French, or Spanish find it easier to follow lectures, ask questions, and build meaningful relationships with professors and peers. France continues to attract students who see French as the gateway to public universities, funded programmes

in areas such as fashion, hospitality, and international relations, and eventually, careers in Francophone organisations. As two of the world's most widely spoken languages, French and Spanish also broaden career prospects across Europe and the wider Western world.

For Gen Z, the growing interest in foreign languages feels less like a

GLOBAL FIRMS AND TOURISM COMPANIES INCREASINGLY VIEW FOREIGN LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY AS A VALUABLE DIFFERENTIATOR

formal academic pursuit and more like a natural extension of their digital lives. The same teenager who scrolls through K-pop fan videos, French cinema clips, or German technology reviews on social media now wants to understand the content without subtitles and interact with creators in their native languages. Duolingo streaks, language-learning apps, and Instagram reels by language educators have made learning German, French, Korean, and Spanish engaging, interactive, and easily shareable rather than purely academic.

The professional advantages are equally crucial. Multinational corporations, tourism companies, global HR and consulting firms, and export-import businesses increasingly view foreign language proficiency as a valuable differentiator. A BTech graduate who can negotiate in German, a commerce student who can read Japanese contracts, or an HR professional who can communicate with French-speaking employees brings greater value to a global organisation than someone who is proficient only in English.

AI-DRIVEN & MULTI-INCOME: CAREER MANTRA FOR INDIA'S GEN Z

33% of Gen Z workers already have or are considering a side hustle to increase their financial security

OUR CORRESPONDENT

India's Gen Z is entering the workforce at a time when AI adoption, rising costs of living, gig work, flexible workspaces and urban commute stress are converging. As a result, Gen Z professionals are rethinking their careers, driven by flexibility, AI fluency and multiple income pathways, rather than a single linear job, said the new research from International Workplace Group (IWG).

Rather than relying on a single employer or role, Gen Z is increasingly building "portfolio careers," combining multiple income streams to future-proof their work in an uncertain economic and

43% HAVE CHANGED ROLES 2 OR 3 TIMES IN THE PAST THREE YEARS, WITH 30% CITING HIGHER SALARY AS THE MAIN MOTIVATOR



technological landscape. This shift is closely tied to the growing influence of AI, with 55% believing it will reshape their careers.

Earning potential remains a key driver. Among those who have changed roles in the past three years, 30% say their main motivation was securing a higher salary and 43%

changed roles two to three times during this period. However, Gen Z is not simply climbing traditional career ladders. Instead, many are adopting "career lily pads," which involves strategically moving between roles, industries and projects to increase earning potential and stay ahead of financial commitments such as rent,

bills and student loan repayments.

For younger workers, the traditional long commute is increasingly seen as outdated. Many want to work closer to home from professional workspaces using technology that allows them to collaborate, network and build their careers without spending hours travelling each day. 65% of Gen Z say they would be less likely to pursue entrepreneurship or multiple careers if required to commute long distances daily. Hybrid and flexible working are enabling this shift by giving young professionals greater control over their time. 24% say hybrid work reduces commuting time, freeing up hours they can reinvest in personal projects or additional income streams.

SHREE AROHAN CHAPTER IV EMPOWERS ASPIRING ENTREPRENEURS

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The fourth edition of Shree Arohan, the annual entrepreneurship summit organised by the Shikshayatan Entrepreneurship Society (SES) of Shri Shikshayatan College, Kolkata, was dedicated not only to fostering entrepreneurial thinking but also to promoting ethical business practices, innovation and entrepreneurship. With the theme, 'Gotham: Rule the Game Before the City Decides Your Fate', the event explored the delicate balance between ambition and ethics in the business world.

The inaugural ceremony on July 11 at the college campus began with the ceremonial lighting of the lamp by Principal Dr Tania Chakraverty, Secretary P K Sharma and CA Vijayshree Panda, along with the guests participating in the panel discussions, including heritage conservationist Iftekhar Ahsan, entrepreneur Suraj Juneja, image consultant Sashi Jain Dugar and



AT SHREE AROHAN, CHAPTER 4, THE MISSION WAS TO STEP INTO THE SHADOWS, IDENTIFY MALPRACTICE, TRACE ITS ROOTS, AND BUILD A CASE FOR A MORE ETHICAL BUSINESS WORLD

Srinjoy Sen. Millennium Post was the media partner for the event. "Since the last edition, it has become an inter-college competition. Through Shree Arohan, we want to foster a startup mindset, encourage entrepreneurial thinking and bring industry leaders onto one platform," said Dr Chakraverty.

More than 13 colleges from Kolkata participated in the summit. Around 25 stalls were set up across classrooms on three floors, where

student entrepreneurs from Shri Shikshayatan College had the opportunity to sell their products, interact with visitors and showcase their ventures.

One of the key highlights of the event was the panel discussion, where Ahsan shared valuable insights on transitioning from digital selling to physical retail spaces. Dugar spoke about how long-term credibility is built by delivering valuable content rather than relying on superficial visuals.

WORLD YOUTH SKILLS DAY 47% EMPLOYERS USING AI IN RECRUITMENT: STUDY

OUR CORRESPONDENT

A massive gap has widened between what employers are willing to pay for external AI talent versus how they are compensating their existing workforces.

According to the inaugural Indeed AI at Work Tracker 2026, 66% of employers state they offer substantial salary premiums for AI-skilled roles.

Among professionals with direct day-to-day AI exposure, 36% saw zero change in their compensation package, while 18% reported a net decrease in their overall earnings. Only a small minority achieved the high-bracket increases advertised in the external job market.

AI is also influencing career decisions. More than half (51%) say AI has significantly or somewhat influenced the types of jobs they apply for or aspire to, suggesting professionals are proactively adapting their career choices as AI adoption grows.

As organizations navigate this transition, the criteria for entering the



AI workforce have fundamentally shifted from pedigree to proof. 40% of employers now explicitly prioritize demonstrable AI skills and certifications over formal university degrees. Only 9% still prioritize an academic degree alone when evaluating candidates for AI roles.

Employees are increasingly recognising this shift in employer expectations. Nearly 37% believe employers now value skills and degrees equally when hiring for AI

roles, while 31% believe AI skills and certifications carry greater weight than formal academic qualifications.

Meanwhile, AI hiring continued to strengthen through 2025, with 63% of employers reporting an increase in recruitment for AI-related roles compared to the previous year. Rather than a dramatic hiring surge, the findings point to steady growth across functions such as AI engineering, strategy, operations, governance and ethics, reflecting how organizations are embedding AI capabilities into their existing workforce.

Despite this growing adaptability, concerns about job security remain.

Around 42% of employees say they feel highly or somewhat anxious about AI's impact on their careers, while anxiety is highest among unemployed job seekers.

AI is also transforming how organisations hire. Nearly 47% of employers already use AI in recruitment, while another 31% plan to introduce AI-powered hiring tools in the coming years, signalling that AI is becoming embedded across both hiring decisions and workforce planning.